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INBRIEF



Geriatric Care marks National Cancer Survivors Day

Geriatric Care commemorated National Cancer Survivors Day with a special gathering in the Geriatric Care Skilled Nursing Facility, Velachery, that brought together cancer survivors, caregivers, families, clinicians, and healthcare teams for an evening centred on resilience and shared experiences, as well as holistic healing. The gathering included a special address by cancer care advocate and author Viji Venkatesh. “Over the years, I have seen that cancer care is sustained not only by medicine but by compassion, community, and the reassurance that no patient has to walk the journey alone,” she said. Rejiv Rajendranath, clinical lead, Geriatric Oncology, also spoke.



Hindu Mission Health Services gets geriatric ward

Sri Sankara Vijayendra Saraswati Swamikal, the 70th head of Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetam, on Wednesday, inaugurated the Pujyasri Jayendra Saraswati Swamikal building at the Hindu Mission Health Services, a multi-specialty hospital in Nanganallur. According to a press release, the building will house a geriatric ward equipped with modern amenities. The hospital has been providing treatment at affordable costs for the past four decades across various fields.

Residents want Highways Dept. to widen CTH Road

The road remains a four-lane facility since 2013 and witnesses traffic snarls with over 1.50 lakh vehicles using it every day. Sources say the proposal to widen the road is under consideration

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Residents living along the busy Chennai Tirupathi High (CTH) Road from Padi to Thiruninravur have urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to direct the Highways Department to take up widening of the 22-km road.

The road, with its many junctions, turns and curves, and thousands of commercial establishments and industrial units, remains a four-lane wide facility since 2013, though more than 1.5 lakh vehicles use it every day.

“On busy days, it takes us nearly two hours to cover the stretch. Motorists cannot travel at more than 30 kmph on this narrow road. Smaller vehicles have to jostle for space with the heavy trucks that use this road from the industrial units in Ambattur, Padi and nearby industrial estates. Accidents are common on this road as there is not enough policing,” said R. Raghunathan, a resident of Ambattur.

Consumer activist and Pattabiram resident T. Sadagopan said roads such as OMR, ECR, and the Thorai-pakkam-Pallavaram Radial Road had taken much less



Choked stretch: Residents say smaller vehicles have to jostle for space with heavy trucks, and accidents are common due to limited policing. DEEPA H. RAMAKRISHNAN

time to widen. “Though this road connects us to Tirupati, an important temple town in the neighbouring State of Andhra Pradesh, we do not have a single bus service to that State on this road. You can also see raw sewage flowing along this State Highway,” he said.

“Every day, new commercial establishments are coming up on both sides. But no provisions are being made for creating parking spaces. As a result, vehicles are parked haphazardly in front of these establishments. We do not think any planning permissions are being granted to these shops. Construction has been taken up at loca-

tions where the Highways Department had made markings,” he added.

Saravanan, a resident of Ambattur, said the road did not have a proper stormwater drain and many stretches were flooded during rain. “Only haphazard work is taken up to restore normalcy. Every election, we raise the issue of widening this road, but nothing happens. Local traders have been objecting to the widening, and the Highways Department has been just about maintaining the road,” he said.

The stretch, which was part of the Chennai-Tirupati National Highway, was handed over to the State Highways Department by

the National Highways Authority of India, which said widening it would not be possible because of urbanisation.

In April 2013, former Chief Minister Jayalalithaa announced that the road would be widened into a six-lane facility. The State government also allocated ₹168 crore for land acquisition. In December 2013, the Highways Department took up work to widen the road end to end wherever land was available, at a cost of ₹98 crore. The road has remained largely unchanged since then.

Highways Department sources said the proposal to widen the road was under active consideration.

Deadlines pass, but private schools fail to display fee structure

R. Aishwaryaa
Meghna M.
CHENNAI

Most schools in the city have failed to display the fee structure at their premises and on websites, even as the deadline for doing so was fixed for June 10. While some matriculation and government-aided institutions in the city have at least displayed the fee structure near their office, other school boards such as CBSE, ICSE, Cambridge, and IB have not displayed anything.

Recently, the Directorate of Private Schools, had directed all private schools of various boards to display their fee structure at the entrance prominently by June 5 and on their websites by June 10. This directive came after the Tamil Nadu State Information Commission directed the department to ensure that all schools display class-wise fee structures at their entrances, websites, and on the admission forms.

Compliance report
The Commission had asked for a compliance report from the Education Department on June 15.

The *Hindu* visited over 15 schools of CBSE, Matriculation, ICSE, Cambridge, and IB boards across the city with most schools furnishing the fee details only when requested for a specific class.

Rekha (name changed), a parent of two children said, “If all schools imple-

The schools were asked to display the fee structure on the premises by June 5 and on their websites by June 10

ment this, it will help those seeking admission for their children. Parents can compare the fees and decide which school is suitable for them. Instead, this information is usually available only at school offices.”

A private school in Gopalapuram had displayed a fee structure showing that the total cost for new admissions ranged from ₹61,000 for pre-KG to ₹79,136 for Classes IX and X, with a breakdown of the application fee, admission fee, tuition fee, development fund, and uniform charges. Some schools, including a primary school in Pulianthope and an ICSE school in Teynampet, displayed only the total fee amount. “The final amount is disclosed only after admission is confirmed. Donation fees are often unclear, and parents are sometimes charged differently, which is unfair,” Ms. Rekha added.

Sources in the School Education Department say it has been a difficult task to get the schools of other boards to furnish fee details. An official said, “We have sent three notices regarding the display of fee structure. We will continue to insist that it be displayed.”

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
(Construction Department)

Open e-Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work:-

S. No.: 1, Name of the work with its location: **Description:** Removal of infringement of 800 KV HVDC transmission line between Tower no. 1806 to 1818 in Biswanath Chari, Assam-Agra comes in the alignment of proposed Raniganj-Araria court section in Supaul-Araria Railway Electrification work, e-Tender No. EL-C-N-MHX-ETEN-12M02-25-26, 2. **Approx Cost of the work :** 36,85,00,461.41, 3. **Cost of Tender form :** Rs. Nil, 4. **Availability of Tender:** On IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Note: In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> at least 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-Tender, 5. **Earnest money to be deposited:** As Per NIT, 6. **Completion period of the work:** 18 months, 7. **Date and time for closing of tender:** 22/06/2026 at 12.00 hrs.

Dy. CEE/Con/North/SPJ
EC Rly, MHX, Patna
PR/0374/CON SPJ/CNST/IT/26-27/44

TURNKEY CONTRACT FOR THE WORK OF SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, COMMISSIONING OF PLANT & EQUIPMENT ETC.

Tender Notice No. : M-TSK-2026-19, Dated: 05-06-2026; E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **Tender No. : M-TSK-2026-19; Name of work :** Turnkey contract for supply, installation and commissioning of Plant & Equipment along with Related infrastructure and Operation of Mechanized Laundry at Dibrugah, collection of soiled linen from coaches from Dibrugah, New Tinsukia and Tinsukia Railway stations and loading of washed linen in coaches at Dibrugah, New Tinsukia and Tinsukia Railway stations for a period of 10 years under BOOT (Build-Own - Operate- Transfer) Model. **Advertised Value:** ₹176,82,39,968.17/-; **Earnest Money:** ₹89.91,200/-; **Last date & time for submission of tender at 15:30 hrs. on 09-07-2026.** Complete information alongwith the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website www.ireps.gov.in

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Hospital Revolving Fund
e-TENDER NOTICE

e-Bids are invited in **Two** bid system (1) **Technical Bid** and (2) **Price Bid** from reputed & genuine Manufacturers/Importers Firms only, for executing a rate contract of "Supply of Surgical Consumables" for a period of two years vide tender No. **PGI/HRF/Surg-872/2026-27**

The detailed terms and conditions such as Tender Fees & EMD of the NIT are available in the e-Bid document uploaded on **e-tender portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> and website of the Institute www.sgpqi.ac.in** w.e.f. **18.06.2026**. The offer will be accepted Online only on e-tender portal with terms & conditions as mentioned in tender document.

- Last date & time of submission of e-bid: **20.07.2026 upto 1600 HRS**
- Date & Time for opening of e-bid: **21.07.2026 at 1200 HRS**

The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any offer partially or fully without assigning any reason.

ADVT. No.: I/23/HRF/2026-27 **DIRECTOR**

MODERN COACH FACTORY, RAEBARELI

On behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/FP, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open tender (Tender Notice No.- M-200/TMC/ FYT Paint Booth /2025-26, Date: 03.06.2026) based on single packet system online through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for following work:-

Description of Work : Works contract for (i) Painting application works of TRC/TRSC/TMC coaches with required consumables & machinery for 65 coaches as per scope of work and (ii) Application work of manual painting activities & allied works of coaches for commissioning of new paint booth & baking oven in new paint shop for 150 coaches as per scope of work., **Approx. Value of Work (Rs.):** ₹ 61,23,433.00, **Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.):** ₹ 1,22,500.00, **Quantity of Work:** 1. 65 coaches, 2. 150 coaches. **Work Completion Period:** 18 Months.

- Tender submitted through online up to 15:00 hrs. on 29.06.2026 which will be opened after 15:00 hrs. through online on <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. Manual offer will not be considered.
- Detailed Tender Notice and Terms & Conditions are available at Indian Railways IREPS website-<http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Dy. Chief Mech. Engr./FP

On behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Fur-II, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open e-tender (No.- M-200/MCF/RBL/FUR- ACTIVITIES/SLRDWW/F-87, Date 05.06.2026) based on single packet system online through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for following work:-

Description of Work : Works contract for interior Mechanical and Electrical Fittings in LSRLD LHB type Coaches with wider window as per scope of work., **Approx. Value (Rs.):** ₹ 3,24,24,437.37, **Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹ 6,48,500.00, **Quantity of Work:** 185 LSRLD Coaches with Schedule -A and Schedule-B, **Work Completion Period:** 09 Months.

- E-Tender submitted through online up to 15:00 hrs. on 29.06.2026. Manual offer will not be considered.
- E-Tender shall be opened on 29.06.2026 after 15:00 through online on <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.
- Detailed E-Tender Notice and Terms & Conditions are available at Indian Railways IREPS website-<http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Dy. Chief Mech. Engr./Furnishing-II

On behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/FP, Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli is inviting open tender (Tender Notice No.- M-200/In House Mfg. S&B/Amrit Bharat/MEMU/2026-27 Date: 05.06.2026) based on single packet system online through Indian Railways portal www.ireps.gov.in for following work:-

Description of Work : Works contract for the work of in-house manufacturing of seat & berth for Amrit Bharat and MEMU coaches as per scope of work., **Approx. Value of Work (Rs.):** ₹ 1,63,53,620.00, **Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.):** ₹ 3,27,100.00, **Quantity of Work:** 1. LWSCN (Amrit Bharat)= 72 coach set, 2. LWS (Amrit Bharat)= 49 coach set, 3. MEMU coaches (DMC/ DMC2/ NDMC) = 27 coach set, 4. MEMU coaches (TC) = 81 coach set, **Work Completion Period:** 12 Months.

- Tender submitted through online up to 15:00 hrs. on 01.07.2026 which will be opened after 15:00 hrs. through online on <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. Manual offer will not be considered.
- Detailed Tender Notice and Terms & Conditions are available at Indian Railways IREPS website-<http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Dy. Chief Mech. Engr./FP

Open tender based on Single packet system Tender Notice No. **MCF/RBL/Tender/ PSM & CPAM/2025-26/C668, Date-06.06.2026**, is invited by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Bogie & Wheel, MCF/RBL through IREPS portal www.ireps.gov.in for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work:-

Description of Work : Complete work on Plate Straightening Machine and Operation of CNC Pro-Arc Machine as per scope of work., **Approx. Value (Rs.):** ₹ 33,72,450.15, **Cost of Tender Document (Rs.):** ₹ Zero, **EMD (Rs.):** ₹ 67,500.00 (Rs. Sixty Seven Thousand Five Hundred) only, **Quantity of Work:** As annexed in chapter VI Bill of Quantities, **Completion Period of Work :** 12 Months.

- **Date & Time of Closing of Tender:** 30.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.
- Detailed Tender Notice, Eligibility Criteria, Terms & Conditions are available at IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in in tender document.

Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Bogie & Wheel

E-Tender Notice No. 03/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL - Corrigendum
With reference to E-Tender Notice No.-03/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE-II/MCF/RBL, it is hereby informed that the date of opening of tender is modified as under:

Particulars	Existing date of opening	Modified date of opening
Date of Opening of Tender	27.06.2026	06.07.2026

Deputy Chief Engineer-II

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CORRIGENDUM NO. 03 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. CON/2026/APR/02 DATED: 20-04-2026

Corrigendum- 03 for Tender No. CE-CON-DK-EPC-2026-02 has been published. For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in

Chief Engineer/CON/NL Project, Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer(Co)/Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works and will be opened at 12:00 hrs. **Sl. No., Tender Notice No. & Description of works** are as follows: 1. **ST-OT-DC-TRACK-KYOSAN-26, Dt. 08.06.2026.** Provision of DC Track circuit for dual detection (Kyosan make EI) in various station yards of Kharagpur division. **Tender Value :** Rs. 17,47,63,944.64, **EMD:** Rs. 34,95,300/-, 2. **ST-OT-DC-TRACK-MEDHA-26, Dt. 08.06.2026.** Provision of DC Track circuit for dual detection (Medha make EI) in various station yards of Kharagpur division. **Tender Value :** Rs. 15,95,80,726.60, **EMD:** Rs. 31,91,600/- **Cost of Tender Document :** Nil for each. **Date of Opening :** 30.06.2026 for each. **Completion Period :** 15 Months for each. **Date of Submission :** up to 12.00 hrs. of 30.06.2026 Interested Tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details description specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. (PR-299)

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CHANGE OF NAME	CHANGE OF NAME
I, CLARA FATHIMA spouse of H.A. Joseph residing at 26/8, Sarada flat, Varadarajan pet main road, Kodambakkam, Chennai-600024. Have Changed my Name from CLARA FATHIMA to CLARA FATHIMA RANI. J vide Affidavit dated 09/June/2026 at Chennai.	I, NIDARSHAN D Nanda Dhayanandan, s/o Neelakantan Dhayanandan (DOB 13.09.2007), residing at Flat 4E, Block - 5, Asvini Amaresa, 77, Kaleshamman Koil St, Ramapuram, Chennai- 600089 shall henceforth be known as NIDARSHAN D NANDA
I, NARENDRAKUMAR S S/o Mr Suresh Kumar Narayanan, aged about 22 yrs R/o. No 3 - Kadamban Street, Arul Murugan Nandavanam Nagar, Near Thangam Borewell Bus Stand, Nannamgalam, Chennai - 600129 do hereby state that in my Aadhar my name is mentioned as Narendrakumar S. Subsequently in my passport my name is mentioned as Narendrakumar. I here by confirm that Narendrakumar S and Narendrakumar are one and same person vide affidavit dt 10.06.2026	Our Son Daksh Makkuni Kumar born on 29.3.2021 Residing at 13, Swan Court, Swan Street, Isleworth TW76XW, United Kingdom. Permanent address No.1, S-Block, 6th Avenue, Annanagar, Chennai-600040 shall henceforth be known as Daksh Padmanabhan Kumar. Deepak Kumar Sampath- Father & Deepthi Padmanabhan- Mother person vide affidavit dt 10.06.2026

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TENDERS

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E-Tender Notice
P2/27/2026-27 11-06-2026
E-tenders are invited from eligible bidders for the Supply of
(1) **Rotary Screw Compressor**
(2) **Muffle Furnace**. Last Date **18-06-2026**. You can download tender documents from www.etenders.kerala.gov.in. For more details visit www.oushadhi.org or contact Purchase Department.
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Maduravoyal MLA P. Rhevanth Charan flagging off an ambulance at Apollo Specialty Hospitals in Vanagaram on Wednesday.

Apollo Hospitals launches cardiac life support ambulances

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Apollo Hospitals, on Wednesday, launched a network of SMART Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ACLS) ambulances.

According to a press release, the fleet was inaugurated at Apollo Specialty Hospitals in Vanagaram by Maduravoyal MLA P. Rhevanth Charan. The ambulance is integrated with AI-enabled computer-aided dispatch, GPS-based real-time tracking, live video telematics and teleconsultation support, and seamless integration with the Hospital Information System. The network is managed by Apollo's Central Operations Command Center.

These vehicles are designed to function as Intensive Care Units on Wheels. By enabling critical medical interventions to begin on road, the initiative aims to minimise treatment delays and improve patient outcomes across Chennai. Ilankumaran Kaliamoorthy, Chief Executive Officer, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai Region, Dhavapalan A., Regional Clinical Director, Emergency Departments, Southern Region, Apollo Hospitals, Vijay Varma S., Chief Operating Officer - Logistics, Apollo Hospitals, and Kaarthik Ramamurthy, Chief Operating Officer, Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Vanagaram were present.

Multi-level car parking to be built at Chennai Port soon

Owing to space constraints, the automobiles for export are parked in different areas, which has resulted in logistical challenges. Around 4,500 cars can be parked in the available space now

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Chennai Port, one of the major automobile export gateways, will soon build a multi-level car parking facility within the port premises to meet growing demand.

According to Chennai Port Authority, a car is exported every 80 seconds from Chennai and Kamaraajar Ports, and in the financial year 2025-26, Chennai Port exported 2,04,165 units of cars. Officials said, in future, the automobile export demand from the Chennai region is only going to increase and hence this project has been planned to accommodate more cars in the port premises. The estimated cost of the project is ₹400 crore.

Chennai Port has been handling significant volumes of passenger vehicle exports for leading auto-



Need of the hour: Officials say automobile export demand from the Chennai region is going to increase and hence the multi-level car parking facility has been planned. REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

mobile manufacturers, including Hyundai Motor India Limited (HMIL) and Kia India. "The Port serves the Sriperumbudur automotive manufacturing cluster, which hosts some of the largest automobile manufacturing facilities in the country and functions as a key export hub for vehicles manufactured in southern India," the request for proposal of the port states.

For the export of automobiles, Chennai Port Authority has a long-term Memorandum of Agree-

ment (MoAs) with both these firms. Currently, the export automobiles are parked in different locations in the port which together make up 59,675 sq.metres of area. In this space, nearly 4,000-4,500 cars can be stationed. But there is a need for accommodating 8,000 cars. Owing to space constraints, the automobiles are parked in different areas which has resulted in longer internal driving distance to the Ro-Ro terminal (Roll-on/Roll-off

terminal—a facility for loading and unloading cargo like cars), and challenges in logistics. "The existing land resources aren't sufficient and horizontally, we have utilised the land to the brim. Hence vertical development is the way to go," a source said.

Officials said they issued the Request For Proposal to rope in a consultant who will prepare the Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the multi-level car parking project. The consultant will look at a host of aspects, including the technical, financial viability of the project and how the facility will enhance the operational efficiency of handling these vehicles. "The consultant may be finalised in about three months. After that, the firm will have another three months to complete the DPR," an official said. Sources said, after this process, the project cost will have to be approved by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways after which the bids can be floated.

Youtuber Mukhtar Ahmed arrested for remarks against racer

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Social Media Investigation Wing of the Central Crime Branch (CCB), Greater Chennai Police, arrested YouTuber Mukhtar Ahmed, 48, on Wednesday for posting a video on YouTube which allegedly had obscene and derogatory remarks against racer Al-isha Abdulla.

This was based on a complaint filed by her on June 3. The complainant said the video uploaded on YouTube channel 'MY INDIA 24X7' had vulgar, derogatory, and sexually coloured remarks about her and her newborn twins, and that it had affected their dignity and privacy.

Subsequently, a case was registered and an investigation was launched. In connection with this case, Tiruchi Suriyaa, son of DMK Rajya Sabha MP Tiruchi Siva, was already ar-

The complainant said the uploaded video had vulgar and sexually coloured remarks about her and her newborn twins

rested on June 4. Mukhtar was apprehended at Mandya, Karnataka, and was remanded in judicial custody in Chennai. It was found that two cases were already pending against him.

Investigations revealed that he had been consistently making defamatory remarks on social media and there were more than 20 complaints pending against him.

City Police Commissioner A. Amalraj said strict legal action will be taken against those who post obscene, derogatory, and unlawful content that target women in websites and on social media platforms.

Police seize 18 kg ganja in separate cases, arrest three persons

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Three persons have been arrested by the Avadi Police Commissionerate for

possessing 18 kg ganja. When the Ambattur Prohibition Enforcement Wing Police, under the Avadi Police Commissionerate, were on patrol at Mee-

nakshi Nagar, Thirumullai-voyal on Tuesday, they intercepted Arunkumar, a resident of Ambattur, based on suspicion. Subsequently, upon search, they

found he had 8 kg ganja that he procured from Odisha for sale, according to a press release.

In another case on the same day, the Poonamal-

lee Prohibition Enforcement Wing intercepted two persons—Sujith and Roy Joy—near Parivakkam signal during surveillance. After questioning and

search, they found each had 5 kg ganja and that they also had procured it from Odisha. All three persons were arrested and investigations are underway.

Timings

CHENNAI

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	30	28
Chennai Airport	40	30
Chennai City	39	30

Chennai Airport Today
40°C The weather will be hot and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. A spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
39°C The morning will be comfortable. The day will be hot and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. Mostly dry weather to occur.

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THE HINDU

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T.N. promoted 7 IAS officers without Centre’s approval, Union Ministry tells court

It tells the Chief Justice's Bench that appropriate administrative action would be taken irrespective of the outcome of a Public Interest Litigation petition filed by an advocate regarding the issue

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Union Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions on Wednesday told the Madras High Court that the Tamil Nadu government had promoted seven IAS officers of the 1995 batch to the grade of Chief Secretary without the Centre's approval.

Appearing before the first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, Additional Solicitor General (ASG) AR.L. Sundaresan said the Centre would initiate necessary action.

The submissions were made just before the Bench dismissed a public interest litigation petition that had challenged a government order (G.O.) issued on December 24, 2025, for promoting the seven officers, including former Finance Secretary T. Udhayachandran, to the grade of Chief Secretary.

The ASG, representing the Union Ministry as well as the Cabinet Secretary, said: “The Government of Tamil Nadu had applied to the Government of India, but we had not granted the approval. Therefore, whatever action we have to take, we will be taking independently irrespective



The submissions were made just before the Bench dismissed a petition that had challenged a G.O. for promoting the seven officers.

of the outcome of this PIL petition.”

‘Exceptional case’

The PIL plea had been filed by Chennai-based advocate M. Balakrishnan. When the judges sought to know how a PIL petition could be entertained in a matter related to government service, the petitioner's counsel replied that it could be entertained in exceptional cases such as the present one.

The counsel said it had become a habit for the State government to promote IAS officers without the approval of the Centre, though the rules applicable to All India Service require the State governments to do so only in consultation with the Centre, since the promotions lead to payment of higher salaries.

Not convinced with the arguments advanced by the counsel on the merits of the case instead of convincing the court on the maintainability of the plea, the judges said a public interest litigation petition filed at the instance of a third party could not be entertained in a government service matter, and that only the officers aggrieved because of the promotions could file a case if they wish to do so.

After taking on file a list of Supreme Court judgments on the issue, submitted by Advocate General Vijay Narayan, the Chief Justice said his Bench would pass a detailed order, giving elaborate reasons for the dismissal of the PIL petition challenging the 2025 G.O.

The G.O. had been issued for promoting IAS of-

icers M.A. Siddique, R. Jaya, P. Senthilkumar, Sandhya Venugopal Sharma, Mr. Udhayachandran, Hitesh Kumar S. Makwana, and B. Chandra Mohan to the Chief Secretary grade of IAS, with effect from January 1, 2026.

At the time of its issuance, Mr. Siddique was serving as the Managing Director of Chennai Metro Rail Limited; Ms. Jaya was in the department of economics and statistics; Mr. Senthilkumar was the Health Secretary; Ms. Sharma was the chairperson of Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation; Mr. Udhayachandran was the Finance Secretary; Mr. Makwana was on central deputation as the Surveyor General of India; and Mr. Mohan was the School Education Secretary.

The G.O. accorded sanction for the creation of temporary posts of Additional Chief Secretary in the departments of Economics and Statistics, Health and Family Welfare, and School Education so that Ms. Jaya, Mr. Senthilkumar and Mr. Mohan could continue to occupy those positions at that point of time. It also said Mr. Makwana shall stand promoted to Chief Secretary cadre without prejudice to his central deputa-

Contesting on DMK’s symbol caused severe distress to MDMK, says Durai Vaiko

K. Muralitharan
CHENNAI

MDMK Principal Secretary and Member of Parliament Durai Vaiko has claimed that the DMK had exerted pressure to prevent his party from contesting on its own symbol in the Assembly election.

This had caused severe distress at all levels of the party, he said. A decision on continuing in the alliance would be taken at the party's general council meeting, scheduled for June 27, he added.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, he explained that at the time of the Assembly election, his party chose to remain in the alliance as it believed that only the DMK-led coalition had the strength to oppose communal forces.

“We believed that communal forces should not enter Tamil Nadu, and that politics based on social justice and Dravidian ideology should continue. At that juncture, when we assessed who had the capability to oppose those communal forces, it was the DMK. Furthermore, regarding [Chief Minister] Vijay, no one predicted that he would win 108 seats and capture power. It was under those circumstances that we decided to continue in the DMK-led alliance,” Mr. Durai Vaiko said.

He, however, said the events that transpired during the election caused severe heartache to him and



Durai Vaiko claimed the DMK had put pressure on the MDMK to prevent it from contesting on its own symbol in the Assembly polls. SHIVARAJ S.

his party cadre. “They coerced us into contesting under the DMK symbol in all the four seats allotted to us. If a party does not contest an election for five years, its registration will be revoked. Against this backdrop, we insisted on contesting under our own symbol and explained the situation to the DMK leadership. Consequently, the DMK president permitted us to contest under our own symbol in one seat (Sirkazhi). But after signing the agreement, severe pressure was exerted on us to contest under the DMK symbol in that constituency as well. Left with no choice, we had to accept it. I view this as anti-democratic. It must be said that this is an unfortunate occurrence within an alliance that talks about social justice and equality,” he said.

He emphasised that victory does not depend solely on having a prominent symbol. “In this election, the ‘Two Leaves’ (AIADMK) and ‘Rising Sun’ (DMK) symbols lost in many places. Conversely, the IUML’s ‘Ladder’ symbol

emerged victorious in a few seats. In the Parliamentary election, we were able to take the ‘Matchbox’ symbol to the public within just 14 days, and I won by a margin of nearly 3,25,000 votes. In this era of social media, it is easy to popularise symbols among the people,” he said.

He recalled that similar pressure was exerted during the Parliamentary election. “At that time, they insisted that I contest under the DMK symbol. I refused. How can the Principal Secretary of a party resign from the MDMK, become a member of the DMK, and then contest? They pressured me till the very end. It was in that situation, while speaking at a meeting, that I declared that I would rather die than contest on any symbol other than our own,” he said.

Attributing the DMK alliance's defeat to the younger generation's desire for change, he pointed out that many of the newly-elected MLAs have no substantial financial backing, political lineage, or caste-based dominance.

FL2 clubs should serve liquor only to members with ID cards: govt.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government on Wednesday said all FL2-licensed clubs should issue membership identity cards to registered members, and serve liquor only to those members and their eligible guests, in accordance with the applicable rules and licence conditions.

According to an official release from the Commissioner of Prohibition and Excise, directions have been issued to all FL2 and FL3-licensed bars and clubs under the provisions of the Tamil Nadu Liquor (Licence and Permit) Rules, 1981.

The prescribed working hours of FL2 and FL3 bars should be strictly adhered to. In FL2-licensed clubs, the operation of a bar should remain only one of the permitted activities. Club managements should ensure that the other recreational, cultural, sports, and social activities for which the clubs are established are conducted regularly, the release said.

Liquor should not be sold, supplied or served to any person below 21 years of age. In cases where the age of a person is in doubt, valid documentary proof of age shall be verified before serving liquor, the release said.

All licence-holders have been directed to ensure strict compliance with the above instructions.

Speaker’s decision to accept MLAs’ resignations challenged in HC

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A public interest litigation petition has been filed in the Madras High Court, challenging Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar's decision to accept the resignations of three MLAs, pending a request to initiate disqualification proceedings against them.

The Desiya Makkal Sakthi Katchi filed the PIL petition, urging the court to quash a gazette notification issued on May 25, 2026, accepting the resignations of Maragatham Kumaravel, S. Jayakumar, and P. Sathyabama, who had represented the Madurantakam, Perundurai, and Dharapuram constituencies, respectively.

Filing an affidavit on behalf of the petitioner party, its president M.L. Ravi told the court that AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami had requested the Speaker to initiate disqualification proceedings against 25 MLAs of his party for reportedly violating the party whip and voting in favour of the TVK government during the confidence motion moved in the House on May 13, 2026.

Even as the request was pending consideration by the Speaker, three out of the 25 MLAs submitted their resignations on May 25, 2026 and joined the TVK on the same day. The Speaker accepted their resignations immediately, and notified the acceptance in the gazette forthwith.

Contending that the MLAs should not be allowed to escape from disqualification proceedings by submitting their resignations, Mr. Ravi said acceptance of such resignations would make the anti-defection mechanism ineffective. He also relied upon a few Supreme Court decisions to buttress his contention.

“The acceptance of resignations during the pendency of disqualification proceedings has the effect of frustrating the constitutional purpose underlying the Tenth Schedule to the Constitution and permits elected representatives to circumvent constitutional scrutiny. Such an approach undermines democratic accountability and dilutes the mandate entrusted by the electorate,” his affidavit said.

The petitioner party also complained about the unnecessary monetary burden thrust upon the public exchequer for conducting byelections whenever MLAs resign within a few days of their election just to escape disqualification proceedings.



GOVERNMENT OF GOA
DIRECTORATE OF TRIBAL WELFARE, PROJECT CELL,
PATTO - PANAJIM
GOA
e-TENDER NOTICE

No. GTWD (Project Cell)/F08/2026/27/03 Dated:- 10/06/2026

This office has published above e-Tender Notices. The details are available on (Website: <https://eprocure.goa.gov.in>). The last date and time for online application for issue & submission of tender bid is 06/07/2026 up to 17:00 hrs. Detailed tender notices may be seen on the notice board of this office. For any Further clarification, The Project Cell of this office may be contacted. DI/ADVT/624/2026



CHENNAI METROPOLITAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICER,
MARKET MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE, KOYAMBEDU WHOLESALE MARKET COMPLEX,
FIRST FLOOR, 'E' ROAD, KOYAMBEDU, CHENNAI - 600 107

E- TENDER NOTICE Date : 10.06.2026

E-Tenders are invited by the Chief Administrative Officer, Market Management Committee, KWMC, Koyambedu, Chennai – 600 107, under Two cover system for the work of “Providing Security arrangement at Koyambedu Wholesale Market Complex, Chennai - 600 107 for a period of One year”.

Tender Notice No.	01/2026-27 dated.10.06.2026
Last date & Time of receipt of E-tenders	13.07.2026 upto 3.00 PM
Downloading the tender document by free of cost	12.06.2026 to 13.07.2026 upto 3.00 PM
For further details visit Website	http://tntenders.gov.in

Chief Administrative Officer,
MMC, KWMC, Chennai - 600 107

DIPR/2036/TENDER/2026

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

C. SANATHKUMAR (77), Retired Senior Sub Editor, The Hindu, Chennai passed away on 10.06.2026. Address : 22-2-150/B, Bhupal Housing Colony, Karakambadi Road, Tirupati - 517507 Contact: 6304689328



Bimla Bhatla
January 10, 1942 - June 02, 2026

With deep love we remember Bimla Bhatla, beloved wife, mother and grandmother.

Her warmth, courage and passion for life will remain in our hearts forever.

With love and fond remembrance
Suchint, Sunil, Murali and Mandira

DEATH

OBITUARY

With deep sorrow and loving remembrance, we inform the passing away of our beloved



Dr. R. Natarajan
24 October 1943 - 10 June 2026

A devoted husband, loving father, affectionate grandfather, and a respected guide to all who knew him, he will be remembered for his warmth, wisdom, kindness, and the love he shared with his family and friends.

He is survived by his wife Dr. Kasturi, son Mr. Dhruva Prakash Natarajan, daughter-in-law Ms. Kalyani Dhruva Prakash, and grandchildren Vihaan and Kiara.

Last prayers : 11:00 a.m. at residence

Address: Y-85, 7th Street, Anna Nagar West, Chennai - 600040

Dhruva Prakash
+91 99625 27167

Funeral: 12:30 p.m. at Velankadu Burial Ground, New Avadi Road

Deeply mourned and fondly remembered by family and friends.

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CPCL’s World Environment Day



CPCL celebrated World Environment Day 2026 recently at its newly launched Company-Owned Company-Operated (COCO) retail outlet, SOOPER, in line with the theme, “Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.” MD, Mr. H. Shankar, Directors Rohit Kumar Agrawala, P. Kannan and S.G. Venkatesh, along with employees, CISF personnel and students, participated in the event. Activities included the flagging off of an environmental awareness campaign van and a tree plantation drive at the outlet.

DAC Opens OMR Satellite Office



DAC Developers Pvt. Ltd. has recently inaugurated its satellite office at OMR. The inauguration was attended by Mr. Gaurav Kumar, Founder and CEO of Yubi Group, and Mr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam, Founder and MD of DAC Developers. The occasion also marked the launch of DAC Cambridge, billed as Chennai's first English-themed residential project, inspired by the architectural style and charm of Cambridge, England. DAC Developers and Yubi have previously partnered on two Chennai transactions, through which Yubi facilitated Rs. 66 crore in funding, while discussions are underway for a proposed Rs. 250 crore land acquisition platform.

Carrier at Rathna Fan House



Carrier Midea India launched its latest air conditioner, the Xceed Edge V Pro, at Rathna Fan House in Chennai. The product was unveiled by Mr. K. Vijay, Managing Director, Rathna Fan House, Depender Redhu, National sales and marketing head, Carrier, and Ankush Bansal India 2 Sales head were present at the launch. The Xceed Edge V Pro introduces smart offline voice control, allowing users to operate the AC with the command ‘Hello Carrier’ and access over 68 voice functions without a remote or internet connection. Key features include built-in Wi-Fi, AI-powered intelligent cooling, 6-in-1 Flexi Cool technology, and 4-way swing airflow for enhanced comfort and energy efficiency.

SASTRA to Introduce Specialisations

SASTRA University will introduce five new minor specialisation programmes for B.Tech. students from the 2026–27 academic year, following approval at its 50th Academic Council meeting. The new minors—Artificial Intelligence, Business & Industry Analysis, Sustainability & Social Engineering, Project & Supply Chain Management, and Economics & Law, aim to equip students with interdisciplinary expertise and a competitive edge. Vice-Chancellor Dr. S. Vaidhyasubramaniam said the initiative seeks to widen opportunities beyond core CSE programmes and support balanced technical education growth. The AI minor will be offered online in collaboration with IIT Ropar through the Vibe MOOC platform, featuring co-teaching by both institutions.

GRT Opens in Rajapalayam



GRT Jewellers recently inaugurated its 67th showroom on Mudangiar Road, Rajapalayam. To commemorate the grand opening, offers including Rs.250 less per gram on Gold jewellery purchase, Rs.150 extra per gram on Old Gold exchange, 12.5 percent off on Diamond and Uncut Diamond value (excluding solitaires), 25 percent off on wastage (VA) for Silver articles, 10 percent off on MRP of Silver jewellery, Double gifts on joining the GRT Golden Eleven Flexi Jewellery Purchase Plan (Offers are not valid on gold coins, Gold bars, or solitaires and cannot be combined with other offers) were introduced. Mr. G.R. ‘Anand’ Ananthapadmanabhan, MD, GRT Jewellers, said, “Every milestone over the last six decades has been possible due to the grace of God and the trust of our customers.” Mr. G.R. Radhakrishnan, MD, GRT Jewellers, added, “While this is our 67th showroom, the excitement and sense of responsibility are just as strong as on the day we opened our first.”

Kamakshi Hospital’s Assisted Living



Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals has inaugurated Dr. K Elder Care Assisted Living in Nanganallur, Chennai, to address the growing demand for professional eldercare, assisted living, and post-hospital recovery services. The facility was inaugurated by geriatric specialist Dr. V.S. Natarajan, Founder of the Dr. V.S. Natarajan Geriatric Foundation in the presence of Dr.T G Govindarajan, Chairman and Founder, Dr.Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals. Designed to combine a home-like environment with professional medical support, the centre offers nursing care, rehabilitation, physiotherapy, doctor consultations, medication management, 24x7 pharmacy and laboratory services, wellness programmes, recreational spaces, and nutritious dining. “At Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, we have always believed that healthcare extends beyond treatment and into every stage of life,” said Dr. T.G. Sivaranjani, Director, Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals.



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From Page One

T.N. government unveils action plan to reduce heat-induced illnesses

It provides for multi-sectoral collaboration and data integration, a roadmap for Tamil Nadu-specific heat risk intelligence, and the way forward.

Besides offering plans for understanding and managing heat-related illnesses and rapid cooling, it provides for specific initiatives by hospitals towards heatwave preparedness.

The HAP also provides for agriculture sector preparedness and response plans, including short-term and long-term actions for heat stress management. Among the mitigation efforts for protection of livestock, it has recommended community-based measures and regulation of livestock housing.

Besides microclimate regulation for the protection of livestock, the HAP has also recommended strategies and actions by the Tamil Nadu Cooperative Milk Producers' Federation Ltd. for animal husbandry. The HAP has also analysed the hazard, exposure, vulnerability, and risk assessment of the districts and cities of Tamil Nadu.

INBRIEF



Former AIADMK Minister P. Benjamin joins DMK

Former AIADMK Minister and the party's former Tiruvallur Central East district secretary, P. Benjamin, joined the DMK on Wednesday. He officially joined the party at Anna Arivalayam in the presence of party president M.K. Stalin. Benjamin, who had been with the AIADMK for a long time, previously served as the Deputy Mayor of the Chennai Corporation. Following the 2016 Assembly election, he served as the Minister for School Education, and later as the Minister for Rural Industries. In the 2026 Assembly election, he contested from the Maduravoyal constituency but was defeated by the TVK candidate. When differences arose within the AIADMK after the elections, he was stripped of the post of district secretary. Speaking after his meeting with Mr. Stalin, Mr. Benjamin said he joined the DMK with the aim to "continue serving the public".

10 monitoring teams formed to address power cuts in Chennai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

As part of measures to promptly rectify power disruptions at night in Chennai and its suburbs due to faults at the distribution level and other reasons, 10 monitoring teams have been formed and 125 patrol vehicles deployed for rapid restoration of electricity supply, Minister for Energy Resources and Law R. Nirmalkumar said on Wednesday.

He flagged off the vehicles at the headquarters of the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited in Chennai. Besides the existing Minnagam centres, 77 Fuse-off Call centres have been established, a release said.

The monitoring teams will oversee major power disruptions in real time, gather information regarding large-scale faults, monitor the progress of restoration works, and provide supply restoration updates to consumers. The teams will also identify areas with recurring faults to provide permanent solution.

Mr. Nirmalkumar told reporters that repeated incidents of power outages had been reported due to damaged electric cables and technical faults. In some places, anti-social elements had deliberately removed power fuses, he said.

Vijay calls on President, Vice-President in Delhi

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay called on President Droupadi Murmu at Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi on Wednesday.

Mr. Vijay, who embarked on a three-day official visit to the national capital to take part in the 11th Governing Council meeting of NITI Aayog on Thursday, departed from Chennai on a special flight on Wednesday morning.

Upon his arrival at the Tamil Nadu House in New Delhi, Chief Secretary M.



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay with President Droupadi Murmu at Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi on Wednesday.

Sai Kumar, Additional Chief Secretary and Chief Resident Commissioner R. Jaya, and other officials welcomed him. Mr. Vijay also received a guard of honour.

In the evening, the Chief

Police file charge-sheet in sexual assault and murder of Suler girl

Wilson Thomas
COIMBATORE

The Coimbatore District Police on Wednesday filed the charge-sheet against the two persons – K. Karthi and R. Mohan – arrested for the abduction, sexual assault, and murder of a 10-year-old girl near Suler on May 21.

The investigating team, headed by Deputy Superintendent of Police Karikal Pari Shankar, submitted the 819-page charge-sheet, which includes 104 prosecution witnesses and 215 documents, before the Special Court for the trial of cases registered under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO)

Act. It was e-filed on Tuesday.

The investigating team took a relatively short time of 18 days to file the charge-sheet after the arrest of the two accused.

"The wilful cooperation from all witnesses was an important factor in the speedy completion of the investigation," said Inspector-General of Police (West Zone) R.V. Ramya Bharathi, who supervised the investigation along with Deputy IGP (Coimbatore Range) P. Saminathan and Coimbatore Superintendent of Police A. Pavan Kumar Reddy.

Karthi, the first accused, was subjected to DNA profiling and a potency test. Cyber analyses were also

done to confirm Karthi's communication with Mohan before and after the crime was committed. Though Mohan knew of the crime, he failed to disclose it to anyone, and misled the police when officers questioned him.

Karthi abducted the girl, whom he knew, from her neighbourhood in Pallapalayam by promising her chocolates. He took her to the private land abutting Kannampalayam tank on a motorcycle and murdered her after sexually assaulting her, the police said.

Sources said blunt force trauma and cumulative effects of injuries sustained to the neck and the chest were the causes of death, as per the post-mortem.

He will take part in the 11th Governing Council meeting of the NITI Aayog on Thursday

Minister called on the President at the Rashtrapati Bhavan.

He also met Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan at his office and held discussions with him.

This was the first time Mr. Vijay met the President and the Vice-President after assuming office as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu.

Later, he met Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi at their residence in Janpath. He held discussions with them.

Meets CPI leader

He also went to the headquarters of the Communist Party of India and met party general secretary D. Raja and other leaders.

On Thursday, Mr. Vijay will take part in the NITI Aayog Governing Council meeting, where he is likely to deliver his speech in the afternoon.

Minister withdraws case against constitution of Fact Check Unit

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

Minister for Energy Resources and Law R. Nirmalkumar on Wednesday withdrew a public interest litigation petition filed by him in 2023, challenging the constitution of a Fact Check Unit (FCU) under the leadership of Iyan Karthikeyan by the then DMK government.

First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan permitted him to withdraw the plea on the basis of the request made by his counsel on record, K. Gowtham Kumar, who said the petitioner was not inclined to pursue the matter in view



R. Nirmalkumar

of the change in circumstances.

Mr. Nirmalkumar had filed the case when he was a member of the AIADMK. He switched allegiance to the TVK in January 2025, and took charge as a Minister last month after the party assumed power in the State.

In his 2023 affidavit, Mr.

plored what was then an unthinkable theme – a psychopathic serial killer driven by extreme misogyny. Director K. Bhagyaraj, an associate of Bharathiraja, appeared in one scene, while director Manivannan was also among his associates, who later emerged as a prominent filmmaker.

In *Nizhalgal*, he introduced actor Ravi, who later became known as 'Nizhalgal' Ravi, and also marked the debut of Vairamuthu as a lyricist. *Ithu Oru Pon Maalai Pozhuthu* and *Poongathave Thaaazh Thiravaai* became enduring hits. With films such as *Tik Tik Tik*, *Niram Maaratha Pookal*, *Nizhalgal*, and *Sigappu Rojakkal*, Bharathiraja demonstrated remarkable versatility.

Vedam Puthithu dealt with the deeply-entrenched caste structure of Tamil society and the he-

gemony of Brahmins. In many ways, it echoed the sentiments of his blockbuster *Alaigal Oivathillai*, which explored a love affair between a Brahmin boy and a Christian girl. The film introduced Karthik and Radha.

Muthal Mariyathai offered thespian Sivaji Ganesan a role marked by immense screen presence with restrained theatrics.

Bharathiraja also acted in some of his films. He was the hero in *Kallukkul Eeram* and donned different roles in other films, including stellar performances in recent years, in films such as *Thiruchitrambalam* with Dhanush and *Thudaram* with Mohanlal.

Bharathiraja also introduced his son Manoj in *Taj Mahal*; Manoj tragically predeceased him. He is survived by his wife and daughter Janani.

Film fraternity bids emotional farewell to legendary filmmaker

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tributes poured in from actors, directors and producers across the country following the death of veteran film director K. Bharathiraja on Wednesday, recalling his immense contribution to Indian cinema.

Many actors, including Rajinikanth, Kamal Haasan, Radhika Sarathkumar, Sivakumar, Radha, Ramarajan, Karthik, Vijayakumar, Rekha, Prabhu, Suriya, and Siddharth paid their respects to the mortal remains of Bharathiraja. Film directors such as S.P. Muthuraman, P. Vasu, R.V. Udayakumar, Cheran, Mysskin and Kasthuri Raja, also paid homage.

The Tamil Nadu Television Digital and OTT Producers Association has announced the suspension of all television shoots for 12 hours, from 6 a.m. on June 11, as a mark of respect to Bharathiraja. The Film Employees Federation of South India and the Society of Television Producers of Southern India also paid their homage.

After paying his respects, actor Rajinikanth said Bharathiraja had been his friend for the last 50 years. "Everyone knows about his accomplishments and talent. He has introduced several actors, technicians and artists, and made immense contributions. Be it actors, direc-

tors or producers, whenever someone faced a problem, he was the first to voice his support for them," he said.

Veteran music director Ilaiyaraaja said: "There's nothing more to say. I pray for his soul to rest in peace." Music composer and filmmaker Gangai Amaran, who was closely associated with Bharathiraja, was also present.

Actor and Makkal Needhi Maiam chief Kamal Haasan said Bharathiraja had made films with him and that he was grateful for it.

Lyricist Vairamuthu described him as a visionary who revolutionised Indian cinema by celebrating rural landscapes and lives.

In his post on X, music director A.R. Rahman, who has composed for Bharathiraja's films, thanked the legendary filmmaker for taking his music to the remote villages of south India.

Actor Mohanlal on 'X' said Bharathiraja was a director who found poetry in the soil, truth in silence, and soul in every frame, and that sharing screen space with him in *Thudaram* was an honour he would cherish forever.

Actor Chiranjeevi said Bharathiraja's films touched millions of hearts and inspired generations of filmmakers. He was fortunate to have worked under his direction as '*Puliraju*' in *Aradhana*.



GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
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Tender No. E-ANGADI-ST-H012-2026-0004-2

In continuation of Notice Inviting Tender, Dated: 10.03.2026. ELCOT Angadi Division invites **second call** for “**Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Maintenance of Microwave connectivity for Police Department**”. Last date for submission of e-bids: **02.07.2026, 3.00 PM**. For complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. For queries: tenders@elcotangadi.in
DIPR/2044/Tender/2026
GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)



TAMIL NADU PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
No.3, TNPSC Road, Chennai - 600 003.
The results of the examination conducted by the Commission for the recruitments mentioned below are available on the Commission's website at www.tnpsc.gov.in:-

Sl. No.	Name of the recruitment	Date of Examination
1.	Combined Technical Services Examination (Interview Posts) (Notification No.08/2025) (List for Physical Certificate Verification and Interview (Phase-II))	20.07.2025 to 22.07.2025 F.N. & A.N. (CBT)
2.	Combined Civil Services Examination-IA (Group-IA Service) (Post of Assistant Conservator of Forests) (Notification No.05/2025) (List for Physical Certificate Verification and Interview)	01.12.2025 F.N. and 08.12.2025 to 10.12.2025 F.N. Descriptive Type (Main Examination)

Chennai - 600 003
Dated : 10.06.2026
DIPR/510/DISPLAY/2026
Controller of Examinations



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH AND NEURO SCIENCES
Institute of National Importance, Bengaluru -560029
Ph: 080 - 2699 5708 / 5127 | www.nimhans.ac.in | Email : recruitment@nimhans.net

No. NIMH/RECT/ADVT-1/B&C/2026-27
Date: 08.06.2026
NOTIFICATION
NIMHANS invites applications for the following vacant posts through offline mode from Indian Nationals residing in India and abroad:

Sl No	Name of the post	Group	No. of vacancy	Category	Pay level (as per 7 th CPC)	Upper Age limit
1	Neuroanaesthesia Technologist	B	1	ST	Level 6 with initial Basic Pay of Rs. 35,400/-	30 years
2	Accountant	B	1	UR	Level 6 with initial Basic Pay of Rs. 35,400/-	30 years
3	Junior Secretarial Assistant	C	1	OBC	Level 2 with initial Basic Pay of Rs. 19,900/-	27 years

IMPORTANT NOTICE:

- Fill the application carefully after reading the given instructions.
- All applicant must go through the detailed advertisement, post and eligibility and ensure that they are eligible in all respect before applying.
- The eligibility of the applicant will be provisional and merely submitting the application form and appearing in examination shall not be treated as validity of eligibility and Candidature shall stands cancelled in case any ineligibility detected at any stage of recruitment process including after joining on an offered post.
- The last date and time for submission of applications is **07.07.2026 up to 04:30 PM**.
- Refer NIMHANS Website www.nimhans.ac.in for detailed Notification.

Sd/-
DIRECTOR

कार्यालय : जिला परिषद्, चतरा।
(Mail Id- db-chatra@jharkhandmail.gov.in)
(E.mail: districtboardchatra@gmail.com)
(अतिअल्पकालिक ईनिविदा आमंत्रण सूचना)

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या - 18/2026-27 दिनांक: 09.06.2026

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी: डी.एम.एफ.टी.

क्र.	प्रखण्ड	पंचायत	ग्राम	योजना का नाम	प्राकालित राशि	परिमण विपत्र का मूल्य	अग्रघन की राशि	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	Tandwa	Bachra north	Hesatu	Construction of High level RCC Girder bridge over Habuadah Nala	22224077	10000	444500	18 months

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि - 20 / 06 / 2026
2. ई-निविदा प्रारंभ की तिथि एवं समय - 22.06.2026 से 29.06.2026 के अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय - 01.07.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे।
4. सरकार द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के आलोक में सभी कामकाज के साथ निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगा।
5. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बैंक कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही संबंधित निविदाकार की होगी।
6. निविदा अमौलिक करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता - जिला अभियंता जिला परिषद् चतरा।
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं - 9835777636
8. विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।
PR 381957 District-(26-27)D

जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद्, चतरा।

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
MATERIAL MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT
E-TENDER NOTICE NO: NIT/14/26/22, Dated: 02-JUNE-2026

Sr. No	Tender No.	Description	Tender Closing/Opening Date	Qty.
1	03261106	DOUBLE ACTING HYDRAULIC SHOCK ABSORBER	22.06.2026	2792 Nos
2	08262029	Industrial Metal Cutting Gas (LPG)	18.06.2026	153248 Kg
3	01261441	High Tensile Transition CB Coupler with Uncoupling Gear	25.06.2026	63 Nos
4	03261373	Knuckle for Centre Buffer Coupler as per RDSO Drg.	24.06.2026	35630 Nos
5	03262440	POH Kit for Constant Contact Polyurethane Side Bearer Pad Assembly (Design A)	22.06.2026	29849 Set
6	03261495	Modified Elastomeric Pad for CASNUB Bogie	23.06.2026	110735 Nos
7	04262388	Submersible copper cable flat 6sq.mm	19.06.2026	20600 Metre
8	07263001	Soft blanket camel/Navy Blue/Grey shade of superior quality to size 215 cms X 120 cms	29.06.2026	24839 Nos
9	03262702	Primary Spring	30.06.2026	2792 Nos
10	06265090	Manufacture and supply of Isolated Special PSC Sleepers for 60 Kg 1 in 12 Turnouts conforming to layout RDSO Drg. No. T-4218Alt-8 (with latest alterations & 1 in 8.5 Turnouts	22.06.2026	37875 Metre
11	03262965	Wear Plate for Yoke-Pin support	22.06.2026	16280 Nos
12	05251315	Digital Modem (nX64Kbps) up to 2 Mbps (Line Driver) and SPECIFICATION NO. RDSO/SPN/TC/80/2020, Revision 2.0	29.06.2026	295 Pair
13	05261203A	Cell 2V 200Ah capacity Lead Acid	25.06.2026	4876 Nos
14	02264014	BRAKE SHOE MEDIUM PHOSPHOROUS	30.06.2026	39338 Nos
15	06265039	Non Linear Junction Detector.	23.06.2026	3 Nos
16	03261003	Helical spring for centerless ground	01.07.2026	581 Nos
17	02263920A	Set of High Capacity (1500 Amps) Traction braking switch drum type (CTF 1, 2, 3) for GP operation of GS/G7/M4 locos.	02.07.2026	11 Set

Tender Closing/Opening Time : At 10:30 hrs.
Railway reserve the right to issue any corrigendum to the tenders. Corrigendum & Important Notice to vendors may be seen in the link www.ireps.gov.in.
AMM/III, For Principal Chief Materials Manager
S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur
CPR/10/175
South East Central Railway
@secrail

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
DRM/Electrical, North Western Railway, Jodhpur for & on behalf of the president of India, invites E-tender for the following works: 1. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website:- <https://www.ireps.gov.in>, 2. Date & time of closing of e-tenders: 30.06.2026 up to 15.00 hrs., 3. Date & time of opening of e-tender: After 15.00 hrs. on 30.06.2026; Tender No.: 02R/2026-27; Name of Work: JU/Gen-Rewiring of staff quarters, service buildings, station buildings and LC gates & other important locations under BGKT power depot of JU Division; Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 28178017.78; Tender No.: 04R/2026-27; Name of Work: JU/Gen-Rewiring of staff quarters, service buildings, station buildings and LC gates & other important locations under MTD & DNA power depot of JU Division; Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 27150760.58; Tender No.: 05R/2026-27; Name of Work: JU/Gen-Rewiring of staff quarters, service buildings, station buildings and LC gates & other important locations under SMR & BME power depot of JU Division; Approx. Cost of the work: Rs.27955188.18; Tender No.: 06R/2026-27; Name of Work: Electrical Work in c/w provision of S&T service building for interlocking of 08 Nos. of manned LC gates i.e. LC-143, 147A, 147, 137 in MTD- JU Section, LC-25, 18,16 in LN-MJ section and LC-80 in RTGH- DNA section over Jodhpur Division; Approx. Cost of the work: Rs.2173257.70; For detailed information visit <https://www.ireps.gov.in> 842-PH/26
Follow us on [Twitter](#) [Facebook](#) [LinkedIn](#) [NWR](#) [Railways](#)

DESIGN, SUPPLY, ERECTION, TESTING & COMMISSIONING WORKS
E-Tender Notice No. DY.CEE/CON/ SCL/02/2026 Dated: 09-06-2026.
Open tender through e-Tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor(s)/firm(s) for the following works: Tender No. EL-CON-NFR-TSS-IMPHAL-01. Name of work: RFP for Engineering, procurement & Construction of Design, Supply, erection, testing & Commissioning of 132/27KV Traction Sub-station, Feeding Post, Shunt Capacitor Bank with Two (2) Nos. of 21.6/30.24 MVA Traction Transformers at Traction Sub-Station Imphal of N.F. Railway in EPC mode. Tender value: ₹12,55,20,525.44/- Earnest Money: ₹25,10,400/- Date & Time of submission of tender: Upto 17.00 hrs. on 15-07-2026 & opening at: 17.00 hrs. on 23-07-2026. The complete information and tender document of above e-Tender will be available at www.ireps.gov.in
Dy.CEE/CON/Silchar
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY (Construction Organisation)
Serving Customers With A Smile

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Open Tender Notice
E-Tender notice no.: CRW-HRT-M-USCLEAN-26-1, Date: 08.06.2026
For and on behalf of President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer-II, Carriage Repair Workshop, Harnaut invites open e-tender for the following works as detailed:-
1. Name of work with its location : "Ultrasonic cleaning of Air brake & Bogie Components at CRW/HRT" 2. Approx. cost of the work: Rs. 2,67,29,684.00 (Rupees Two Crore sixty seven lakh twenty nine thousand six hundred sixty four only).
3. Cost of Tender Form : Nil, 4. Earnest Money to be deposited : Rs. 5,34,600.00 (Rupees Five lakhs thirty four thousand six hundred only).
5. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of Tender : The tender have to be submitted online on <https://www.ireps.gov.in> website up to 11.00 hrs. on 29.06.2026 and will be opened on the same day at 11:15 hrs.,
6. Website particulars, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. : Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website: <https://www.ireps.gov.in> & full details of notice can be seen on notice board in the office of Chief Workshop Manager, Administrative Building, Carriage Repair Workshop, Harnaut, Nalanda, Bihar 803110. All corrigendum will be uploaded on website if required.
Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer-II/
Carriage Repair Workshop/Harnaut
PR/0377/CRW-HRT/MECH/T/26-27/44

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder
Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in



Scan the QR code to register your feedback

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कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
राष्ट्रीय उच्च पथ प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग
पी०टी०सी० ग्राउण्ड के दक्षिण, हजारीबाग - 825301
फैक्स/फोन - 06546-222474
E-mail :- nhddivisionhazaribagh@gmail.com / eenhazarib-jhr@nic.in
TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE
इस कार्यालय की अति-अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना - NH/HAZARIBAGH/ 2026-27/01 जो PR No. - 380812 Road (26-27)_D द्वारा दिनांक 27.05.2026 को विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित है, को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निरस्त किया जाता है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
राउण्ड पथ प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI
Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
3 Weekend Online Training Program on
Government Certified Professional Course on
Python Application with Open AI

Date: 13th, 14th, 20th, 21st, 27th & 28th June 2026 Time: 9.30 a.m. to 1.30 p.m.
Contents : Introduction to Open AI Products & Python Basics, Overview of Open AI Products (Chat GPT), GPT-5, DALL-E2, Whisper GPT, Open AI API, Open AI Gym, Open AI Codex) Building Chat Applications with ChatGPT, Advanced Conversational AI with GPT-4, Generating Art with DALL-E2, Speech Processing with Whisper, Leveraging GPT for Text Generation, Open AI Gym for Reinforcement Learning, Automating Coding Tasks with Open AI Codes, Integrating Multiple Open AI Products into a Single Application, Designing and Implementing a Project that Combines Chat, Text Generation, Image Generation, Speech Processing Reinforcement Learning, Testing, Debugging and Optimizing the Integrated Application, Presentation and Demonstration of the Capstone Project, Discussion on Future Directions & Advancements in AI Integration with Python, Capstone Project: Building an Integrated Application and many more.
COURSE FEE : Rs. 8,260/- (Incl. GST)
Fees to be paid throu Online www.ctfchennai.in
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GOVT OF INDIA CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED TO SUCCESSFUL CANDIDATES

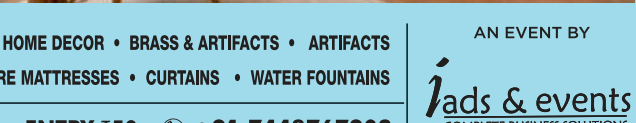
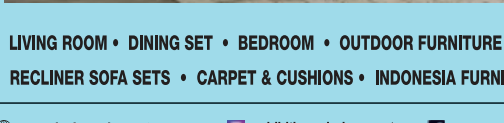
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11th - 15th JUNE 2026
(10.00 AM TO 8.30 PM)
CHENNAI TRADE CENTER
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INBRIEF



Wild jumbo attack claims one more life in Wayanad

A 65-year-old man was killed in a wild elephant attack in Wayanad of Kerala on Wednesday. The victim was attacked while forest officers and residents were attempting to drive the elephant away after it entered a populated area. Just a day earlier, a woman was killed in an elephant attack in Idukki. Forest Minister Shibu Baby John has issued directives to form a 500-member special reserve force to address the increasing hardships faced by people due to wild elephant attacks.

From June 15, free bus ride for Kerala women, trans people

The Kerala Cabinet on Wednesday decided to implement the free bus travel scheme for women and transgender people on ordinary services of the Kerala State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) from June 15 onwards. Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said the scheme titled ‘Priyadarshini’ was being limited to ordinary services in the first phase. He said the concession would be available to women of all ages and irrespective of their financial background.

Drug smugglers clash with police in A.P.; four nabbed

The Alluri Sitharama Raju district police fired two rounds in the air, after a group of ganja smugglers allegedly attempted to attack personnel with stones, during a vehicle checking operation at Meduru village in Andhra Pradesh on Wednesday. According to sources, the incident occurred when the police were conducting routine vehicle inspections in the area. Four of the suspects who were allegedly transporting ganja from Odisha were caught.

Death toll in explosion at A.P. steel plant rises to nine

Harish Gilai
VISAKHAPATNAM

The death toll in the explosion at the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (VSP) rose to nine on Wednesday, after a critically injured contract worker died of burns while undergoing treatment at MGM Seven Hills Hospital. The worker, Paidiraju, 50, was a resident of Gangavaram in Gajuwaka. He is survived by his wife and two sons. Paidiraju was among the six workers seriously injured in the blast at SMS-1 of the VSP on Monday. According to hospital sources, he had suffered more than 90% burns. Despite receiving intensive care, he died on Wednesday. The body was shifted to King George Hospital for a post-mortem.

‘Neglecting workers’
Meanwhile, YSRCP president Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy on Wednesday accused the NDA government of failing to protect the VSP from privatisation and neglecting the welfare of its employees. Referring to NDA leaders’ announcement that each affected family would receive benefits worth ₹1.72 crore, he alleged that most of the amount comprised the employee’s own retirement benefits. “Out of the ₹1.72 crore being cited, nearly ₹1.45 crore comes from the worker’s retirement benefits. The Centre is providing ₹25 lakh, while ₹2 lakh is coming from the PM’s Relief Fund. The State is not contributing a single rupee,” the YSRCP leader alleged. He demanded that the government announce an ex gratia of ₹1 crore to the families of those who died.

₹2,533-cr. facilities to be built for Central staff in Amaravati

In Cabinet meeting chaired by PM Modi, two major projects in the A.P. capital were approved; they are aimed at creating modern office, residential infrastructure for Central government employees

Sambasiva Rao M.
AMARAVATI

In a significant boost to the development of Andhra Pradesh’s capital city Amaravati, the Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday approved two major Central government infrastructure projects, with a revised combined estimated cost of over ₹2,533 crore. The approved projects include the Central Government General Pool Office Accommodation (CGGPOA) and the General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA), which are aimed at creating modern office and residential infrastructure for the Central government employees in the capital.



On the anvil: The proposed Central government residential complex at Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

According to the decision, the CGGPOA project will be developed at an estimated cost of ₹1,299.08 crore, with a total built-up area of 23.25 lakh square feet. The project is intended to provide office accommodation for Central government departments and agencies.

The GPRA project, designed to provide residential facilities for government employees, has been approved at an estimated cost of ₹1,234.91 crore.

Green structures
The housing complex will have a built-up area of

31.30 lakh square feet. The projects have been planned with a strong focus on sustainability and green infrastructure. The buildings will have a minimum GRIHA 4-Star rating, comply with the Energy Conservation and Sustainable Building Code (ECSBC) 2024 standards and incorporate energy-efficient and environmentally friendly design features. The Cabinet also focused on inclusive development, and said the proposed campuses would be barrier-free and accessible for Divyangjan (persons with disabilities). The projects will include modern civic and community facilities to improve the quality of life for residents and employees.

No AI use for White Paper, says Kerala CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Reacting to the charge that sensitive financial data were exposed in the preparation of the White Paper on Kerala’s fiscal health, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on Wednesday said former Finance Minister K.N. Balagopal was the first to reveal the cash balance in the Treasury. He also denied the allegation that artificial intelligence (AI) was used to draft the White Paper. He

was reacting to CPI(M) leader and former Finance Minister T.M. Thomas Isaac’s charge that sensitive Finance Department information, such as treasury cash balance data, had been divulged to external sources and that “substantial portions” of the White Paper, tabled in the Assembly on June 4, were AI-generated. Mr. Satheesan said AI tools were not used in this specific instance. Former Union Cabinet Secretary K.M. Chandrasekhar, who

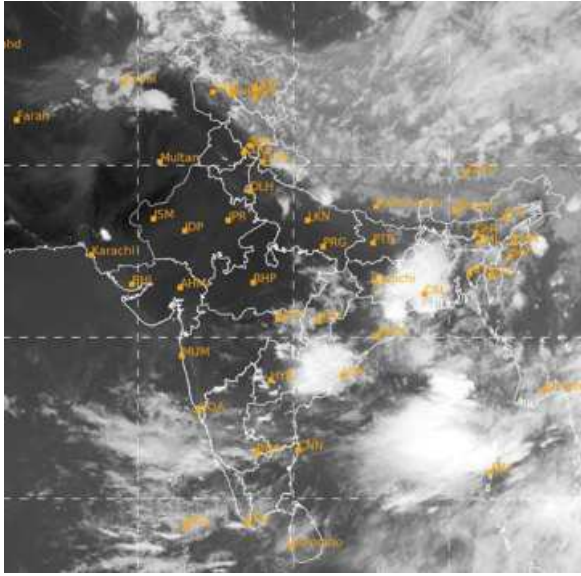
headed the panel that drafted the White Paper, himself had denied that AI was used, he said. “Even if AI was used, what is wrong with it? The government intends to use AI tools for data-driven governance,” the Chief Minister said.

‘Short of ₹20,500 crore’
Mr. Satheesan also reiterated his concern that the State Plan would be short of ₹20,500 crore due to a higher anticipation in the 2026-27 Budget estimates than the provision for Ker-

ala made by 16th Finance Commission. He described the shortfall as “unexpected”. Mr. Balagopal said that his disclosure of the cash balance pertained to the final figures at the end of the financial year. Handing over details of government transactions, confidential statistics and reports handled by the secret sections of the Finance department to an external group (the panel that drafted the White Paper) was a wrong decision, he added.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Konkani & Goa, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karikal, Kerala, Lakshadweep and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	42	32.4	23.7	Kurnool	36.6	26.9	
Ahmedabad	42	42.8	29.7	Lucknow	41.4	29.4	
Aizawl	24.6	31.5	19.6	Madurai	37.5	27.1	
Bengaluru	0.1	29.9	21.8	Mangaluru	9	29.2	23.6
Bhopal	40.4	27.6		Mumbai	0.1	35.3	29.5
Bhubaneswar	38.4	28.9		Mysuru	31.4	21.2	
Chandigarh	42.7	29.4		New Delhi	0.3	42.4	29.1
Chennai	39.2	30.2		Patna	38.5	28.2	
Coimbatore	1	32.0	23.0	Port Blair	19	30.0	26.0
Dehradun	36.9	23.2		Prayagraj	6.2	43.6	26.4
Gangtok	22.8	17.1		Puducherry	38.9	29.1	
Goa	33	31.9	24.0	Pune	36.3	27.0	
Guwahati	6	32.6	25.5	Raipur	5	42.2	29.0
Hubballi	29.0	23.0		Ranchi	36.9	26.0	
Hyderabad	16	38.1	23.7	Shillong	24.8	16.5	
Imphal	17	31.4	22.8	Shimla	31.6	22.0	
Jaipur	42.1	30.4		Srinagar	32.3	14.2	
Kochi	28	29.2	24.2	Thiruvananthapuram	1	31.6	25.4
Kohima	26.0	18.0		Tiruchirappalli	38.1	28.0	
Kolkata	35.8	30.0		Vijayawada	41.0	39.4	
Kozhikode	44	31.4	24.6	Visakhapatnam	36.6	31.0	

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)
Pollutants in the air you are breathing
Yesterday
In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Gurugram, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 264 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu recorded a healthy AQI score of 27
Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Heat relief



Shades of summer: Residents seek respite under the shade of trees along Beach Road in Visakhapatnam on Wednesday as clouds gather after temperatures touched around 41 degrees Celsius, offering relief from the searing summer heat. K.R. DEEPAK

Telangana BJP helped dig up case against M.P. Cong. leader

Ravi Reddy
HYDERABAD

In a dramatic, time-bound operation, Telangana BJP leaders played a pivotal behind-the-scenes role in the rejection of Congress leader and former MP Mee-nakshi Natarajan’s nomination for a Rajya Sabha seat from Madhya Pradesh. Party sources described the sequence as a race against time that unfolded over four hours, triggered by a query from the national leadership on whether any case was pending against Ms. Natarajan in Hyderabad, where she serves as AICC in-charge. Caught off guard by the query, a senior Telangana BJP functionary initiated a rapid verification exercise, mobilising the party’s legal

cell. The urgency stemmed from the narrow window available to challenge nominations before scrutiny deadlines closed. Twists and turns
After searches for FIRs against the Congress leader yielded no result, the breakthrough came during the second phase, when the team reached out to practising advocates to ascertain whether any private complaints had been filed in court. An advocate tipped off the team about a private petition filed in a Nampally court by a woman, primarily against Congress leader Kumbham Shiv Kumar Reddy, in which Ms. Natarajan and others were respondents. The BJP legal team’s next challenge was to se-

cure proof. According to party insiders, the team managed to obtain copies of the petition and the court notice issued to all respondents. However, the most crucial element remained whether Ms. Natarajan had responded to the notice. By around 3 p.m., the BJP leaders had gathered the complete set of documents, including the counter filed by the Congress leader. Based on the material submitted, the Returning Officer ultimately rejected Ms. Natarajan’s nomination, a decision that reportedly caught Congress leaders off guard and triggered political ripples beyond Madhya Pradesh. For her part, Ms. Natarajan, in her counter to the court, denied all allegations.

A.P. Police bust child trafficking gang, rescue 15 Bihari children

The Hindu Bureau
ONGOLE

Fifteen children from Bihar were reportedly rescued by the Prakasam District Child Welfare Committee (CWC) at the Ongole railway station, Andhra Pradesh, while travelling on the Jogbani-Erode Amrit Bharat Express (16602) on Tuesday evening. The police arrested a child trafficking gang of 12 members who were allegedly involved in exploiting the children to various factories in Tamil Nadu. The rescue operation was carried out through the joint efforts of Government Railway Police (GRP)

The traffickers were involved in putting the children to work as daily labourers at factories in T.N.

and Railway Protection Force (RPF), along with voluntary organisations – HELP (Helping Entire Lower and rural People), SARDS (Social Activities For Rural Development Society), Association for Voluntary Action (AVA), and Society for Integrated Rural Development (SFIRD). On the orders of District Collector P. Raja Babu, the children were presented before District Joint Collector Kalpana Kumari, who

further directed the police to take strict legal action against those who were involved in the trafficking. She also instructed them to ascertain the specific districts in Bihar from which the children hailed and to inform their parents to ensure their safe return to native places. Following the orders of the Joint Collector, accommodation was arranged for the children at the District Social Welfare Hostel to be a temporary shelter under the CWC. HELP Foundation project director B.V. Sagar, along with CWC and District Child Protection Officer (DCPO) P. Dinesh Kumar visited the children on Wednesday.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Observing that courts cannot remain “mute spectators” when the well-being of voiceless animals is at stake, the Supreme Court has directed the Kerala government to take custody of Uttoly Raman, a well-known elephant in the State, and shift it to a rescue and rehabilitation centre pending a final decision on its ownership. The SC Bench said it was compelled to pass the direction after finding that the tusker had been subjected to commercial exploitation, and used in rituals despite an earlier order prohibiting it.



Contempt of court: Jumbo Uttoly Raman was used in ceremonial processions despite a prohibitory order. REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

“In the given circumstances, where the issue pertaining to the custody of the elephant in question is yet to be decided; and with a view to prioritise the health and overall well-being of the elephant, this court deems it appropriate

to direct the State of Kerala to take over the custody of the elephant, and house it in a rescue/rehabilitation centre,” the Bench said in an interim order. The order came on a contempt plea by Jayakrishnan Menon. He alleged

that Krishnankutty, who had been granted temporary custody of the elephant amid a dispute involving the Mata Amritanandamayee Mutt, had violated an assurance given to the court that Raman would not be used for “commercial or temple activities”. “It is truly unfortunate that the elephant in question... has been subjected to commercial exploitation despite an order restraining such exploitation, that too on the strength of an undertaking made before this court,” the Bench said. It also imposed a fine of ₹2,000 on Mr. Krishnankutty, finding him guilty of breaching the undertaking furnished to the court.

Negotiating federalism in higher education

Higher education in India has emerged as an important site through which the changing dynamics of Indian federalism are being expressed. Issues relating to regulatory authority, curriculum, language policy, public funding, and digital governance have transformed the sector into a critical site where competing visions of the Union and State governments intersect. These developments not only shape the direction of higher education but also illuminate broader questions concerning the distribution of power within the Indian Union. As a result, governance of higher education can no longer be viewed merely as a sectoral policy concern; rather, it has become an integral component of India's evolving federal architecture.

Some recent examples include the contestations surrounding the implementation of the National Education Policy (NEP), 2020 across different States. Recent regulatory reforms facilitating the establishment of foreign university campuses in India have also generated varied responses from State governments, reflecting differing perspectives. This fragmented political landscape has important implications for higher education governance in the country. However, they have received only relatively limited attention.

Growing influence of Centre Several developments have illustrated these tensions. In Tamil Nadu, the State government repeatedly opposed various aspects of the NEP 2020, particularly the three-language formula as well as the University Grants Commission's (UGC) circular on the third language this year. Centre-State tensions in higher education were also evident in the disputes over the appointment of Vice-Chancellors and the powers of Governors in States such as Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, and West Bengal.



Eldho Mathews

is with the Kerala State Higher Education Council. Views expressed are personal

Although education remains constitutionally within the Concurrent List, the prevailing governance dynamic increasingly favours the Union

Although education remains constitutionally within the Concurrent List, which gives both the Union and the States legislative authority, the prevailing governance dynamic increasingly favours the Union. Through the Ministry of Education, the UGC, and various regulatory and accreditation bodies, the Union government possesses substantial leverage over universities and colleges across the country.

The introduction of the NEP, 2020 is an important restructuring attempt to redesign the architecture of higher education in India. The policy has proposed sweeping reforms, including four-year undergraduate programmes, an Academic Bank of Credits, institutional restructuring, multidisciplinary universities, and internationalisation initiatives. These reforms also represent an expansion of the influence of the Centre into domains that have historically been the preserve of State governments.

Moreover, access to central funding now is increasingly dependent on compliance with nationally designed reform agendas. Programmes such as the Institutions of Eminence initiative and competitive research mechanisms under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation have contributed to the influence of the Union government over States' authority.

The role of national regulatory agencies has also become another important site of conflict. The structures proposed by the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025, which are intended to replace existing higher education regulatory bodies including the UGC, have generated apprehensions regarding the gradual erosion of the authority of State governments. Another important dimension to centralisation is digital governance. Mechanisms such as the Academic Bank of Credits have expanded the capacity of the Union government to standardise

and monitor higher education governance across States. In States with strong regional political identities, these reforms are viewed not just as administrative issues but as constitutional questions concerning the balance of power within the Indian Union.

Strategic adaptation Interestingly, the implementation of the NEP, 2020 has also revealed that Centre-State relations in higher education are not purely adversarial. Rather than adopting positions of complete acceptance or outright rejection, many States, including Opposition-ruled States, have selectively adapted aspects of reforms in accordance with local political contexts. This reflects the emergence of a more negotiated form of federalism characterised by strategic adaptation.

For instance, with respect to internationalisation, several States are seeking to position themselves as regional education hubs by facilitating partnerships with overseas institutions. These developments underscore the growing recognition of higher education as a strategic instrument for global visibility and knowledge-driven development. The debate surrounding the establishment of international branch campuses further illustrates this change. While the regulatory framework and policy direction are largely determined by the Union government, the actual implementation of such initiatives depends substantially on State governments through local administrative clearances, infrastructure support, and investment facilitation.

As India's regional political landscape continues to evolve, the trajectory of higher education governance will depend not only on constitutional provisions or national-level policy frameworks, but also on the capacity of the Centre and the States to negotiate competing political and developmental priorities within the federal structure.

Why TVK is eager to woo AIADMK cadre

Tamil Nadu's ruling party is strengthening itself by welcoming rival members

STATE OF PLAY

T. Ramakrishnan

The recent defection of a large number of former Ministers and legislators belonging to the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) to the Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam (TVK) has prompted many to wonder whether the ruling party is seeking to build its organisational network through these latest recruits.

Even though it is well known that the Vijay Makkal Iyakkam (VMI), a voluntary organisation made up of newly elected Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's fans, has provided the much-needed manpower for the TVK, there is a perception in certain quarters that the ruling party has not yet acquired enough strength on the ground. Under such circumstances, it is quite natural that the TVK follows an "open-door policy" for anyone with political experience, especially from the AIADMK, which has finished third in the April-May Assembly election. There have been accretions to the ruling party from the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) too but the TVK's keenness to woo as many cadres as it can from the AIADMK is clearly evident. At an event to mark the admission of the defectors last week, one of the prominent faces of the new regime and Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna said that "the AIADMK and the TVK are one and the same. The TVK is not a different party but [like] a parent body." This observation has prompted leaders and observers to describe the TVK as "a new AIADMK."

The main reason why the ruling party is targeting the



Dravidian major is the latter's comparative weakness in relation to its traditional adversary, the DMK. The depth of its defeat can be appreciated better if one is to take a close look at how it suffered electoral reverses in the 2026 Assembly poll. Apart from winning only 47 Assembly seats (against 66 seats in 2021), the party forfeited deposit in 19 seats, the highest so far. But the DMK, which contested four seats more than the AIADMK's 172, did not forfeit deposit in any constituency. In terms of vote share in contested seats, the DMK fared better with 32.17% as against the other's 28.7%.

A new alternative

There is one school of thought within the AIADMK, as articulated by general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami late last week, that the party's performance was not as poor as it was in 1996 when it secured only four seats and that of the DMK's in 1991 when it won just two seats. But there is one qualitative difference between 2026 and 1991 and 1996 – there was no credible third alternative force available then, unlike the TVK now. Besides, the number of seats where both the Dravidian majors forfeited deposits was much lower – 3 for the DMK in 1991 and 2 for the AIADMK in 1996. Moreover, as regards the AIADMK, the signals were out even in the 2024 Lok Sabha

polls when the party forfeited, for the first time in a parliamentary election, deposits in seven constituencies. It is against this backdrop that the TVK, which has catapulted to power in the recent polls, is consolidating its position.

There are a few more compelling factors for the ruling party to take under its fold members of the AIADMK. In the Assembly polls, the TVK drew a blank in eight districts including Villupuram (with seven Assembly constituencies) and Nagapattinam-Mayiladuthurai-Tiruvavur (put together, 10 seats). It knows that it has to have a strong base in all these areas, even though no leading figure from these places was there in the latest round of defectors.

In addition, local body polls are going to be held in eight months, as declared by Mr. Arjuna a couple of days ago. Rural local bodies in 28 districts, which comprise 9,581 village panchayats, 314 panchayat union councils, and 28 district panchayats, do not have elected representatives. The term of such bodies in nine other districts will be over in four months. In February next year, the term of all major urban local bodies will also end. Going by all indications, the authorities would like to have elections to the rural and urban local bodies together. This is why the Minister has challenged the DMK asking whether it would be able to bag mayorship even in one municipal corporation.

It may be the hope of the TVK that if the party were to come out with flying colours in the local body polls, it can make moves, both politically and administratively, much more confidently than it has done so far.

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Major lacunae in reporting industrial accidents

The inconsistencies in the data compiled by the Labour Bureau and the DGFASLI point to severe lapses in reporting of industrial accidents

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy
Pon Vasanth B.A.

The death toll from the explosion at the Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited-Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (RINL-VSP) on June 8, rose to nine on Wednesday. Following the incident, a familiar chain of bureaucratic responses has been triggered such as ex-gratia for the bereaved families and the constitution of an expert committee for a high-level probe. These were the same measures taken after the last major accident at the plant in 2014, and indeed after most workplace accidents across the country. But India appears to be lagging in strengthening institutional mechanisms needed to prevent such accidents (Chart 2).

The problem begins with the very collection of safety data, as the gaps in the annual Standard Reference Notes (SRNs) of the Directorate General Factory Advice Service and Labour Institutes (DGFASLI) reveal. DGFASLI helps implement the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSH) Code, 2020. The OSH, for which the rules were notified only last month, renamed the DGFASLI as the Directorate General of Occupational Safety and Health.

Each SRN records industrial accidents in two sections: one from data compiled by the Labour Bureau and the other from DGFASLI's own correspondence with Chief Inspectors of Factories. The two never match, pointing to lapses in reporting (Chart 3).

The reports also show DGFASLI struggling with heavy vacancies (Chart 4). The country does not have enough factory inspectors, even in industrialised States such as Tamil Nadu (Chart 5). This gets consequently reflected in the small fraction of factories inspected each year (Chart 6). Moreover, many States simply do not report the required details (Chart 7).



Flames erupt in a steel plant after molten iron spills while being moved in a bucket by a crane in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh, on Monday, June 8. PTI

Chart 5: Inspectors per factory among the States with the highest number of factories as of 2023

	Number of factories	Inspectors of Factories	Factories per inspector
Tamil Nadu	50,669	106	478
Gujarat	49,246	81	608
Maharashtra	39,533	44	898
Haryana	25,607	35	732
A.P.	24,642	42	587
Kerala	22,601	53	426
Telangana	22,118	27	819
Karnataka	18,389	48	383
Delhi	13,616	7	1,945
Rajasthan	11,014	27	408



Institutional apathy

Data for the charts were sourced from Standard Reference Notes (SRNs) and Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India (ADSI) reports. With inputs from Nitika Francis and Sandhya K, who is interning with The Hindu

Chart 1: Deaths (red) and injuries (blue) reported in fire accidents in factories, as per ADSI reports

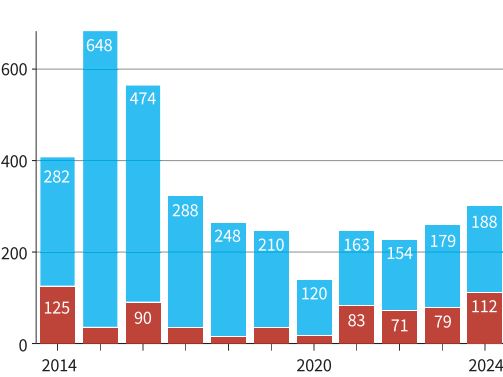
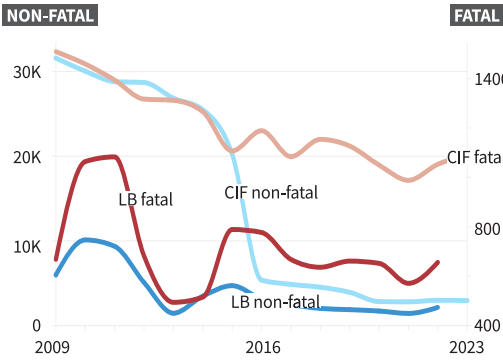


Chart 3: Fatal and non-fatal injuries as per the Labour Bureau (LB) and (CIFs), which vary widely over the years, with a few showing unexplained swings in the SRNS



Besides wide variations within the SRNs between the LB and CIFs' data, the fire accidents captured by them were only a third of the numbers reported in ADSI reports

Chart 6: The share of factories inspected by DGFASLI each year (in %). The inspections have dropped significantly in the recent years, perhaps due to the staff crunch

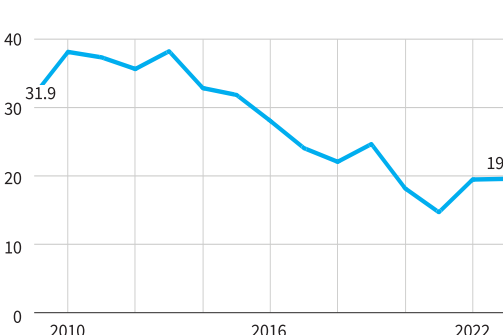


Chart 2: The number of registered factories in each year (blue) and the number of employees in millions (red)

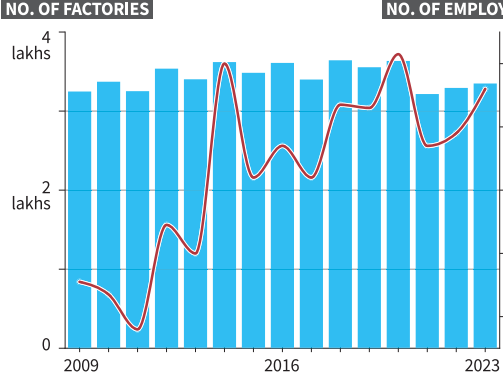


Chart 4: The year-wise vacancies (red) and filled positions (blue) in DGFASLI. Nearly 50% of the 349 sanctioned posts remained vacant as of 2023

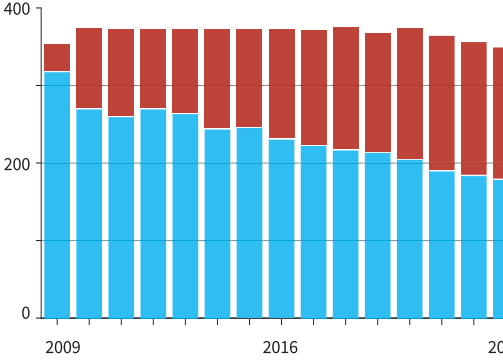
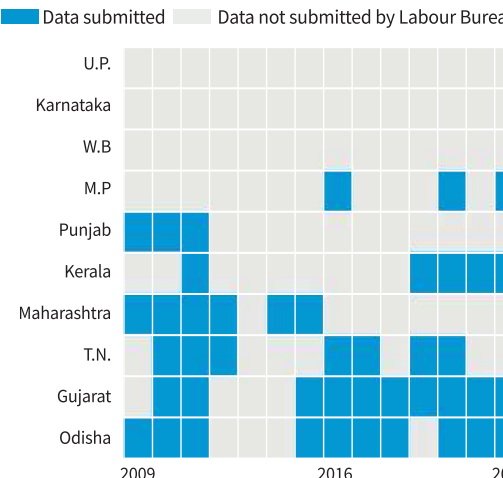


Chart 7: Many States did not furnish data on fatal and non-fatal incidents, either to the Labour Bureau, or DGFASLI, as per the SRNs. U.P., Karnataka and W.B. did not provide data even once



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUN 11, 1976

Decline in pen exports

With domestic sales of over Rs. 60 crores India's pen industry entered the world market in the late Fifties. In 1973-74 these exports touched Rs. 80 lakhs. Next year they were down to almost half and in 1975-76 they dipped further.

Examining the how and why of this low performance we came on a story of bad business practices and of adverse conditions in the international market.

The export figure of Rs. 80 lakhs was possible with an active sales campaign to spot new markets. Till then the market for Indian pens was confined to the West Asian and African countries, where the filler tube fountain pen and the ink containing ones made by us were acceptable. These exports were of the order of Rs. 30 lakhs to Rs. 40 lakhs. Then, through the massive sales campaign launched by an export trading house, Poland came in with orders worth Rs. 37 lakhs. These were mostly for ball point pens, a commodity in which Indian expertise is not yet perfect.

The magic of export earnings attracted all and sundry manufacturers of ball pens to chip into the huge order. As their consignments reached the cold climate of Poland, the pen's nozzles got blocked with the frozen ink. The following year the Poles ordered for a mere Rs. 3.2 lakhs from India. Exporters may blame the manufacturers, but the Poles have gone elsewhere for their pens. With the Polish order reduced to a mere Rs 3.2 lakhs, pen exports in 1974-75 dropped to Rs. 42.9 lakhs. In the year ended March 1976 these exports dropped further to Rs. 42.3 lakhs when the target was for Rs. 75 lakhs.

According to one exporter the explanation for this dip ties in the troubled situation in West Asia. Lebanon has been buying a fair amount of India pens since the early Sixties. Since then there has been a gradual decline in Lebanese imports as the civil war in that country gathered momentum.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 11, 1926

Wimbledon jubilee

London, June 10: The King and Queen will attend the opening day at Wimbledon on 21st June. All living past champions in Ladies Singles, Men's Singles, and Men's Doubles have been notified by All-England Club to be in attendance when the King will present them with Jubilee Commemoration Medals.



Director's cue: Bharathiraja with actors Aruna and Vijayashanthi while filming *Kallukkul Eeram*. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Enduring classic: Bharathiraja and actor Sridevi with the team of the film *16 Vayathinile*. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Caught on camera: A still of directors K. Balachander and Bharathiraja from the film *Rettaisuzhi*. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Big Three: Actors Rajinikanth and Kamal Haasan with director Bharathiraja at an event in Chennai in 2017. M. VEDHAN

Tales behind his timeless classic *Muthal Mariyathai*



Director Bharathiraja with legendary actor Sivaji Ganesan. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

One of director Bharathiraja's masterpieces, *Muthal Mariyathai*, which portrayed the love between an ageing hero and a young woman, had its genesis in the love story of Russian writer Fyodor Dostoevsky and Anna Snitkina, who was 25 years younger than him.

Thespian Sivaji Ganesan and Radha played the lead roles in the film adaptation of the story. The song *Vetiveru Vaasam Vedalapulai Nesam*, composed by Ilaiyaraaja, encapsulated the story in a nutshell.

R. Selvaraj, Tamil film story writer and a close associate of Bharathiraja, recalls: "Initially, everyone was quick to write off the film as a flop. Producer and writer Panchu Arunachalam said the horse would lose the race. Music director Ilaiyaraaja also had reservations about the film's success. But the movie proved everyone wrong and became a major hit," he said.

It was Selvaraj's idea to include the scene in which Radha receives a strand of Sivaji Ganesan's silver hair as a memento.

When many people had given up on *Muthal Mariyathai*, Bharathiraja organised a special screening exclusively for women. "He handed each of them a sheet of paper and asked them to write their opinion. More than 40 women described it as a fantastic film. It was then that Bharathiraja decided to go ahead with the release," recalled Mr. Selvaraj.

Engaging stories, strong heroines define director Bharathiraja's repertoire

Bharathiraja decided he was done with conventional tropes of the hero, baddie, and a hanger-on heroine; he ensured that his gentle view of love and fierce view of society on celluloid would endure

Ramya Kannan
CHENNAI

As Bharathiraja breezed into Tamil cinema with *16 Vayathinile* with a sylvan landscape, he not only transformed what was being shown on screen but also brought in a new grammar for characterisation in Tamil cinema.

With fresh eyes, groomed on a rural story line in the lush surroundings of Theni in south Tamil Nadu, Bharathiraja decided he was done with the conventional tropes of the hero, the baddie, and a hanger-on heroine. Interestingly, this director who introduced a number of heroes and heroines, found that his heroines became iconic stars, while the heroes, with a few exceptions, got by. In this, lies the subtext of how Bharathiraja imagined and sculpted his *dramatis personae* – strong women, mellow heroes, and a liberal spattering of motley characters adding depth to the storytelling.

Midas touch

This asymmetric attention that Bharathiraja pays to male and female characters emerges over his repertoire of films. Repeatedly, the heroines stand out in relief, while the heroes redefine "heroism". It is well known that Bharathiraja had a Midas touch in introducing heroines. Besides Radha, Radikaa, Revathy, Rekha, and Ranjitha, his 'R series' of heroines, Vijayashanti, an action heroine, also got a foothold in cinema thanks to him.

Take Mayil, for instance, in *16*

Vayathinile. Sridevi dazzles as a school girl whose vulnerabilities and strengths remain the pivot of the film. The men, whether it is Kamal Hassan's Chappani or Rajinikanth's Parattaiyan, never mind what position on the good-evil spectrum they may lie, are all destined to circumnavigate Mayil. For those seeking heroes in the movies, Bharathiraja offers Chappani, a man drawing courage and support from the heroine, a 'mellow hero'.

While Bharathiraja gave Chappani a noticeable limp, he also dared to give thespian Sivaji Ganesan age in the classic *Muthal Mariyathai*. In his masterpiece about love between an aged man and a young woman, Sivaji is the "mellow hero", his silver hair used as a metaphor and as a sign of the vulnerability that defines his screen character. In the "other" woman, Kuyilu, played by

Bharathiraja's rich legacy includes warm characters, fallible heroes, and cultural context

Radha, why, even in the fire-spitting wife, the shrewish Ponnatha essayed brilliantly by Vadivukkarasi, Bharathiraja places that perfect foil to showcase Sivaji's mellow Malaichamy.

Show stealer

Even in *Mann Vasana*, where, on his debut, Pandian plays a cocky, carefree youth, it's clear he is rustic and naïve. It is Revathy, again on a debut that steals the show as Muthupeci who navigates the innocence of first love, the pain of separation, and the struggles of a young widow. A Revathy starrer again, the 1983 movie *Pudhumai Penn* pulled all the stops out taking a feminist line, boldly and unapologetically.

In *Kadolaru Kavithaigal*, it is Sathiyaraj as Chinnappa Das, a bully who undergoes the transformation in the story, but everyone who has

watched the film knows that it is Jennifer teacher (Rekha) who is the fulcrum, the transformative agent. Again, setting off two completely polar characters against each other, Bharathiraja delivers another version of his romantic storytelling.

But Bharathiraja also pivoted, later in his career, to fixate on social issues. In the process, he created strong characters again, but as vessels for his ideas on social reform. There can be no better example for this than *Vedam Puthithu*, arguably the director's boldest, politically charged masterpiece. An unapologetic critique of the rigid caste system, Brahminical hegemony, and religious hypocrisy, it uses the character of Sathiyaraj as Balu Thevar, and a child to deliver punches that rent the existing fabric of society.

Even *Alaigal Oivathillai*, an ostensible love story, explores the bitter complications of inter-religious love and marriage, in a touching tale refreshingly told with debut artists Radha and Karthik, thrown together in young love.

In *Karuthamma*, the hero and heroine take a backseat and the overarching theme of female foeticide drives the film. In *Kizhakku Seemaiyle*, with a striking essay by Radikaa, the villain, but also the primary driver of the film, is a family feud that tears apart siblings.

Bharathiraja's rich legacy leaves us not only with glorious locales, but also with warm characters, fallible heroes, strong heroines, extraordinarily bold storylines, fierce criticism, and deep cultural contexts. As he leaves the world, he has ensured that his gentle view of love and fierce view of society on celluloid will endure.

En iniya Thamizh makkale: unforgettable celluloid legacy of a son of the soil

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
CHENNAI

"*En iniya* Thamizh makkale (My dear Tamil people)," the prefatory line, marinated in love and warmth, has now become part of the mists of time. Legendary director Bharathiraja would utter these words as a preamble just before his celluloid offerings commenced.

It was his classic signature, one that hinted at another film rooted in Tamil Nadu's landscape and pulsating with its rural heart.

When Bharathiraja passed away on Wednesday, Tamil cinema lost one of its greatest auteurs. Ailing at 84, and being heartbroken after losing his son Manoj last year, the director, who launched a multitude of actors and directors, was in his twilight.

The Rajinikanth-Kamal Haasan duopoly may have its roots in the K. Balachander school, but it was Bharathiraja who offered them the road not taken through his stellar *16 Vayathinile*, also starring a wonderful Sridevi. The 1977 hit, steeped equally in the innocence and misogyny typical of a village, was the stuff of legend, and it yanked Tamil cinema from the stuffy confines of studios, and made outdoor shooting the preferred norm.

Versatile genius

Paddy fields, sugarcane farms and palm trees may have been his preferred background, but the versatile genius could also make a serial killer film, *Sigappu Rojakkal*, with Kamal doing a villainous turn.

Bharathiraja delved into social issues with gusto, he held a mirror, never flinched and his range was broad.

There was women's emancipation in *Pudhumai Penn*, the tender romance between an older man and a younger woman in *Muthal Mariyathai* with thespian Sivaji Ganesan and Radha dishing out a bravu-



Heartbreaking loss: Bharathiraja encouraged young talent and launched a slew of actors. THE HINDU ARCHIVES

Bharathiraja delved into social issues with gusto, he held a mirror, never flinched and his range was broad

ra performance, and a scathing expose on female foeticide in *Karuthamma*.

The perils of caste were focused upon in *Vedam Puthithu*, and equally, Bharathiraja could helm a commercial revenge saga through *Oru Kaidhiyin Diary*, also remade in Hindi as *Aakhree Raasta*.

Ear for music

He launched a slew of heroines ranging from Radikaa to Revathi, and had a fetish of renaming his heroines with names starting with the letter 'R'. Actor Karthik too debuted under Bharathiraja in *Alaigal Oivathillai*. Fine music was intrinsic in this ace director's movie adventures, and to this day, there is chatter both about *Nizhalgal's* script and songs. Be it Ilaiyaraaja or A.R. Rahman, Bharathiraja could tap into their soul and glean their finest creative outputs.

He also inspired his assistant directors to carve their own path, and K. Bhagyaraj, R. Parthiban, and Pandiarajan all evolved from the Bharathiraja school of thought. Bhagyaraj, out of reverence, al-

ways referred to Bharathiraja as "*enga* director", and it was a bond that lasted decades.

As age and ailments caught up, Bharathiraja found a second wind in acting. Be it the wily politician in Mani Ratnam's *Aayitha Ezhuthu* or the old stunt master in Mohan Lal's Malayalam blockbuster *Thudaram*, the former director invested gravitas and believability into these characters.

Young talent

Supremely aware of his craft and very secure in his domain, Bharathiraja encouraged young talent. Always effusive in his praise, he would say in his unique English: "What a fellow, what a film, look at that climax, the framing, I told myself '*dei* Bharathiraja *nee out*.'" When he appreciated Mari Selvaraj's *Pariyerum Perumal*, it metaphorically signalled the passing of the baton from one rural cinematic master to another peering wide at the Tamil hinterland.

Like the title of one of his hits, *Mann Vasana*, Bharathiraja's films evoked the smell of the soil.

As Tamil filmdom lapse into grief, his films will stand the test of time, reminding us of a man, hailing from the leeward side of the Western Ghats, moving to Madras, while his affectionate gaze remained locked on the villages he left behind.

Bharathiraja and Ilaiyaraaja: a relationship that ebbed and flowed

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

It was a friendship that weathered hardship, poverty, and adversity before each of the buddies scaled great heights in the film world.

The friendship between Bharathiraja and maestro Ilaiyaraaja and his brothers Gangai Amaran and the late Bhaskar spans more than half a century, though it had its share of ups and downs. Bharathiraja and Ilaiyaraaja parted ways after working together for years, but eventually rekindled their friendship.

Ilaiyaraaja and Gangai Amaran paid their last respects to their long-time friend on Wednesday.

"I pray from the bottom of my heart that his soul

rests in peace. The relationship I shared with him was the same as the one I shared with all of you. It is my destiny to love this land, its people and its artists. I pray to the Almighty," Mr. Ilaiyaraaja said.

Stories of struggle

The moment inevitably brought back memories of their struggle to gain a foothold in the film industry. However, even before the movie *16 Vayathinile*, Ilaiyaraaja had announced his arrival in a big way with *Annakili*.

The songs of *16 Vayathinile*, soaked in rustic charm and folk melodies, captured the imagination of the people. *Senthoora Poove*, penned by Gangai Amaran, won the national

award for singer S. Janaki.

Recalling those difficult days in a conversation with *The Hindu* in 2018, Ilaiyaraaja said that in 1968, he, his brothers and a few friends boarded a bus to Chennai in search of a career in the film industry. The journey was anything but easy. Bharathiraja, who had worked with them in staging dramas, had already arrived in Chennai hoping to become an actor. Instead, he could find work only at a petrol bunk.

The group was forced to move into a small portion of a house at the end of Gangai Amman Koil Street, opposite Ram Theatre in Kodambakkam, after being evicted from a mansion where only three people were permitted to stay. Ka-

mala, a singer in their troupe, arranged accommodation for them in an outhouse and allowed them to store their musical instruments at her house.

"Farming activities were still taking place in the area. Whenever I wanted to meet Dhanraj Master, I would take the 12B bus. The conductor, whose nickname was Fiddle, never charged me for a ticket. If a ticket inspector boarded the bus, he would immediately issue one to me," Mr. Ilaiyaraaja recalled.

A 'Navaratri' tradition

That year, heavy rain during *Navaratri* made life difficult. "There was waist-deep water everywhere and we had nothing to eat. Bharathiraja, my brother

Bhaskar and I collected puffed rice and *pottu kadalai* distributed at shops from Ram Theatre to the Vadapalani Murugan Temple in paper cones made from *The Hindu* newspaper. For three days, we survived on that and water," he said.

When he later narrated the incident to his wife, she suggested that food be served at their house for 10 days during *Navaratri* every year and it still continues.

Though Bharathiraja and Mr. Ilaiyaraaja together made memorable films and songs, difference of opinion between them led to Bharathiraja roping in music director Devendran for the film *Vedam Puthithu*.

They again worked to-

gether for *En Uyir Thozhan*, *Puthunellu Puthunaathu*, and *Nadodi Thendral*. Once again differences cropped up between them and A.R. Rahman became the sought-after music director for Bharathiraja from *Kizhakku Seemaiyle*.

A reunion that wasn't

However, the duo agreed to work together in 2020 for the film *Aatha*. Writer and film director Bharathi Krishnakumar, who has penned the story for the movie, told *The Hindu* then: "After 28 years, they are going to work together and it is again for a rural theme."

The production was supposed to start after the COVID-19 pandemic, but it never took off.



Friendship through the ages: Film director Bharathiraja and maestro Ilaiyaraaja. STILL S RAVI

A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



Ministry rescinds Quality Control Order on cotton bales

The Textiles Ministry on Tuesday said it had rescinded a 2023 Quality Control Order (QCO) on cotton bales with immediate effect. The government recently suspended the 11% import duty on cotton till October 30, 2026. “We think imports will increase as already 40 lakh bales have been imported. We expect 15 lakh-20 lakh more bales to come in this cotton season,” said Nishant Asher, secretary of the Indian Cotton Federation.

Govt. okays 22 more applicants under PLI scheme for textiles

The Union government has approved 22 new applicants that are expected to bring in total investment of ₹2,339.14 crore in the latest round of approvals under the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for textiles. According to an official press release these companies will generate a projected turnover of ₹15,561.34 crore in notified products, and create 36,217 employment opportunities across the textile value chain.

SEBI mulls limiting AMC’s top employees salary disclosure

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed to disclose salaries of asset management company (AMC) senior executives only as a group as against the current individual level disclosure, according to a consultation paper released on June 10. Further, SEBI proposed that the remuneration of fund managers can be given on “request basis.” The proposal comes after feedback that granular disclosure was not required for mutual funds.

Govt. mulls capping airport ‘bundles’ for privatisation

Limiting the number of bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder at 2 to 3, or roughly 5 to 6 airports, for the third round of privatisation involving 11 airports is aimed at preventing ‘oligopoly’

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Civil Aviation has proposed capping the number of airport bundles that can be awarded to a single bidder at “two to three bundles”, or roughly five to six airports, for the third round of airport privatisation involving 11 airports, in order to prevent an “oligopoly”.

The move comes even as the Adani Group, which had no presence in airport operations till a decade ago, has grown to become the country’s largest private airport operator.

The recommendation was made last week in response to queries raised by government departments represented on the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC), which is reviewing the Ministry of Civil Aviation’s proposal to privatise 11 airports that was submitted in December 2025, according to a per-



Holding sway: Adani Group acquired GVK’s majority stake in Navi Mumbai and Mumbai airports, expanding its portfolio to eight. PTI

son familiar with the matter.

“It is important to ensure other bidders have a fair opportunity to participate. Otherwise, it could discourage future investment in the sector,” the person added.

The 11 airports proposed for privatisation have been grouped into five bundles, each comprising a mix of metro and non-metro airports to improve the commercial viability of smaller airports. The bundles are: Amritsar and Kangra; Varanasi,

Kushinagar and Gaya; Bhubaneswar and Hubli; Raipur and Aurangabad; and Trichy and Tirupati.

The committee also sought clarifications on a range of issues including the minimum capital expenditure requirements for each airport bundle to ensure that smaller airports receive adequate investment and do not suffer from neglect.

If the constituent departments of the PPPAC are satisfied with the Ministry’s responses, it may grant an in-principle ap-

proval. In February 2019, during the second round of airport privatisation, the Adani Group emerged as the successful bidder for all six airports on offer. At the time, the conglomerate had no prior experience in operating airports.

In July 2019, *The Hindu* reported that the PPPAC had brushed aside key recommendations made by the Department of Economic Affairs and the NITI Aayog to improve the criteria for selection of bidders, which included capping the number of airports that can be awarded to a single player to two, as well as prior airport operational and management experience.

Later, the Adani Group also acquired GVK’s majority stake in Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports, expanding its airport portfolio to eight facilities. Together, these airports handle around 78 million passengers annually, accounting for nearly 25% of India’s air traffic.

Equity MF inflows slip to one-year low of ₹22,900 cr. in May

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Net inflows into equity mutual funds dipped 40% to ₹22,907 crore in May 2026 from the previous month, according to monthly data of the Association of Mutual Funds of India (AMFI).

The inflows had already moderated ever since the beginning of the calendar year – in January and February – even before the West Asia conflict. Investors had shown resilience despite lukewarm returns on their funds throughout 2025 with July 2025 inflows going as high as ₹42,702 crore. This momentum normalised in the subsequent months.

“The moderation in flows can largely be attributed to a combination of factors. Equity markets witnessed some recovery from the corrections seen earlier in the year, reducing the urgency among investors to deploy incremental capital during periods of weakness,” said Himanshu Srivastava, Principal, Manager Research, Morningstar Investment Research India.

“Elevated valuations in certain pockets of the market, particularly within the broader market segments, may have also prompted some investors to adopt a more measured approach,” he said.

“In addition, the global backdrop remained uncertain, with concerns around the trajectory of global growth, evolving geopolitical developments, and the

Investments through systematic investment plans (SIPs) also dipped to ₹30,954 crore

future path of interest rates continuing to influence investor sentiment. Against this backdrop, some degree of profit booking and temporary caution from lump-sum investors appears to have weighed on overall flows,” he added.

The shift from equity to gold ETFs, too, faded with a net outflow of ₹725 crore. To be sure, multiple gold ETFs have halted large scale lumpsum subscriptions in light of an expected increase of increasing foreign exchange rate.

“The reversal appears to have been driven by a combination of profit booking following the earlier rally in gold prices and a shift in investor risk appetite, with some rotation away from safe-haven assets,” said Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst at Morningstar.

SIPs too dip

Investments through systematic investment plans (SIPs) also dipped to ₹30,954 crore in May 2026, from ₹31,115 crore in the previous month.

The number of contributing SIP accounts stayed at a little more than 9 crore accounts for the second consecutive month. However, 3 lakh new SIPs were registered taking the number to 54 lakh accounts in May 2026.

Life insurers’ new business rose 5% in May to ₹32,031 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Life insurers’ New business premium (NBP) rose more than 5% year-on-year in May to ₹32,030.84 crore even as number of policies/schemes sold were a tad lower. Market leader LIC reported a 3.5% NBP rise to ₹19,042.16 crore.

LIC mobilised ₹4,584.1 crore (₹4,030.2 crore) in individual premium and ₹14,458.1 crore (₹14,374.9



LIC secured ₹4,584.1-cr. NBP.

crore) in group premium. It issued 10.35 lakh policies/schemes (10.68 lakh

The 26 private life insur-

ers together logged over 7% NBP rise to ₹12,988.68 crore, per Life Insurance Council data. It came on 5% increase in number of policies/schemes issued to 6,35,567.

Emkay Research commented the protection segment is expected to have maintained momentum in May, while the savings business, including linked and non-linked products, likely saw some softness on geopolitical tensions.

‘Data centre power use to rise 26% in ’26’

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Global data centre electricity consumption is expected to rise by 26% in 2026, forecast Gartner Inc, a research advisory firm.

It was estimated the worldwide data centre electricity consumption would reach 565 TWh in 2026, a rise from 447 TWh in 2025. Gartner further projected global data centre power demands in-

creasing by 27% year-over-year, reaching 132 GW in 2026 and almost doubling to 290 GW by 2030.

AI-optimised servers are expected to be the primary driver of increased power consumption.

Linglan Wang, director analyst, Gartner, said power availability has become a key constraint in expanding AI capacity, making energy security a critical factor in the global race to scale AI operations.

Industry hired 1.18 lakh flexi workers in last 12 months: ISF

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Indian Staffing Federation (ISF), the apex body for the flexi-staffing industry in India, said despite cautious market sentiment in 2025 and 2026 on account of geopolitical uncertainties, the industry added 1.18 lakh new formal flexi workers over the last 12 months recording an 8% year-on-year growth in employment.

As per ISF’s annual report for FY25-26, the total formal flexi staff employed by members reached 1.91 million as of March 2026. The federation attributed the growth to rising formalisation of employment and sustained demand across sectors despite global challenges.

IT recovery

The report also highlighted a recovery of the IT staffing segment, which logged a

10.1% y-o-y rise in new employment. ISF VP Farhan Azmi said GCCs accounted for 73% of new hiring mandates, driving growth in the sector.

ISF ED Suchita Dutta said its members continued expanding formal employment despite subdued economic environment, adding chunk of workers belonged to the 18-25 year age group, highlighting their strong presence in the workforce.

Zee to raise \$241 million for strategic initiatives

Reuters

Indian television broadcaster Zee Entertainment said on Wednesday it would raise \$241.43 million to fund its strategic and business initiatives.

The company, which did not disclose a medium for the raise, said the board will deliberate further on options for raising funds.

The fundraise comes days after the broadcaster struck a deal with FIFA to broadcast the 2026 World Cup in India, ending uncertainty over the tournament’s availability in one of the last major markets where rights remained unsold.

The deal covers 39 FIFA events over eight years through 2034 and includes the next World Cup in 2030. The company had expanded its presence in sports broadcasting by launching a dedicated portfolio of sports channels.

Indian reservoirs can host 102 GW floating solar capacity, shows report

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

India’s reservoirs can host about 102 gigawatt (GW) of floating solar capacity, as per the first comprehensive national assessment of the technology’s potential by the National Institute of Solar Energy, an autonomous institute of the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy. The report titled “Solar PV Potential of India (Floating Solar)” frames panels on water as a way around one of the most intractable obstacles in the solar sector – land.

The assessment, however, has no calculation of what it would cost to realise this potential. Its only cost reference is a 2021 benchmark from U.S. National Renewable Energy Laboratory, which the report cites to note floating units cost about 25% more upfront than ground-mounted ones.

“We are in discussions with the Finance Ministry to promote floating solar and agri-photovoltaics,” Santosh Kumar Sarangi, Secretary, MNRE said. Agri-photovoltaics refer to



Power on water: An aerial view of the floating solar panels on the Mudasarlova reservoir in Visakhapatnam.

farm beds that are sheltered by structures on which solar panels are mounted.

Acquiring land

Ground-mounted solar systems, which dominate India’s about 100 GW of installed solar capacity, need 3-4 times more area/MW than the panels themselves occupy. Land acquisition, which is costly, slow and prone to conflict with agriculture and habitation, continues to be a chokepoint as India pursues 500 GW non-fossil capacity by 2030.

NISE arrived at its estimate

by passing India’s inland water bodies via six geospatial filters: lakes and reservoirs larger than 10 hectare, water present for at least 11 months/year, depths of 3-30 metre, solar irradiance above 4.5 kWh/m²/day and proximity within 10 km of roads and substations.

Demonstrated at Odisha’s Hirakud reservoir, the filters whittled 499 sq. km. of water down to 99.5 sq. km. of usable surface. Applied nationwide, they yielded 1,946 sq. km. of feasible area with a self-imposed cap of 20% of any reser-

voir’s surface, translating to 102.18 GW. Maharashtra (16.28 GW), Madhya Pradesh (14.89 GW), Karnataka (13.69 GW), Odisha (12.81 GW) and Telangana (10.72 GW) account for the bulk.

Flagship solar park

India’s flagship is the Omkareshwar floating solar park on River Narmada in Madhya Pradesh’s Khandwa district – at 278 MW, the country’s largest with plans to scale to 600 MW. Yet NISE’s field observations there recorded loosening float joints, misaligned platforms and uneven buoyancy alongside reports from developers of electric cables breaking.

Globally, floating solar reached about 9.6 GW by 2024, almost 90% of it in Asia. China leads with installations such as a 120 MW plant on fish farm in Poyang Lake; Singapore’s 1 MW Tengeh reservoir test bed supplied much of the field’s performance data and Netherlands accounts for about 3/4th of Europe’s capacity built largely on quarry lakes.

Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Limited
Kagithapuram - 639 136. Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu.

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

Tender No.	Material Description	Due date
262713 001593	Procurement of Fuel Oil for Unit - I	22.06.2026
262713 001602	Procurement of Filler grade Precipitated Calcium Carbonate (in Jumbo Bag) for Unit - I	18.06.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites : www.tnpl.com / <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

DIPR/2031/Tender/2026 **TNPL - Maker of bagasse based eco-friendly Paper**

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
No.CE/PHD/ACCTS-03/26/204,
dtd.03.06.2026
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE

Name of the work: "Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of 2.00 MLD STP-I in front of Trade Centre-II for two years (2026-28)."

Estimated cost: Rs.1,56,38,972.10

Last Date & time of submission: 24.06.2026 up to 17:30 Hrs.

Refer our website for details: eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
PHD, PPA

PPA/PR/15/2026-2027 dtd. 09.06.2026

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File No. HO/CIVIL/T&E/E-5417/04/2026 16121 Date : 04/06/26

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL), IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR
BID IDENTIFICATION No.CIVIL/EST/17/2026-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : RFP for Authority Engineer/Independent Engineer for the Assignment of "Re-development of Veer Surendra Sai University of Technology (VSSUT) Burla, Sambalpur, Odisha".

2. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
i. Start Date : 17:00 Hours of dt.10.06.2026
ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt.03.07.2026
iii. Opening date : 11:30 Hours of dt.04.07.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Sd/-
Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar

4001/143/2627 OIPR-4001/40751/126-27/0045

HAVE FUN

Neymar wants to enjoy every moment of the World Cup



AFP

Brazil forward Neymar said that he felt like a “kid” ahead of what will be his fourth and “final” World Cup, which could yet risk being derailed by a nagging calf injury. “I am like an 18-year-old going to his first World Cup. I am going to enjoy every second and every moment. I hope it will be special as well,” said Neymar.

FULLY RECOVERED

Messi makes an appearance and scores a goal in Argentina’s friendly



GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Messi is ready for his sixth World Cup. After recovering from an injury, the captain of the reigning champion played 20 minutes and scored a penalty in Argentina’s 3-0 victory over Iceland in Alabama on Tuesday in its final tune-up match before the World Cup. Messi is the all-time top scorer for Argentina (117 goals).

DETERMINED

I’ll be at the next WC in 2030: barred Somali referee Artan



AFP

Somali referee Omar Artan, who was denied entry into the USA for the World Cup, returned to a hero’s welcome in Mogadishu and vowed to take part in the tournament in 2030. “I will be at the next World Cup and will continue to make Somalia proud. Despite what has happened to me, I am not discouraged,” Artan said.

MIND GAMES

England not among the top favourites, reckons Tuchel



REUTERS

We are not the top favourites. We cannot be because we have not won it for so many years. There are proven winners in the tournament with more success in recent years. It is my opinion and conviction that once you reach the quarterfinals, you can go all the way — England manager Thomas Tuchel.

Will expansion of dream lead to explosion of quality?

North America will welcome 48 teams for football’s biggest tournament; while Argentina, Spain and France are among the favourites, many emerging nations believe that they can cause an upset

FIFA WORLD CUP

Avon Sengupta

The World Cup has a habit of redefining football’s hierarchy. New stars emerge, established powers fall and careers are forever defined by a handful of moments.

As the tournament heads to North America for the first time since 1994, the game is at a crossroads. Argentina is attempting to become the first team since Brazil in 1962 to retain the World Cup. Kylian Mbappe is looking to cement his place at the top of the game, while Spain’s young stars seek to fulfil their promise. And there remain questions over what a 48-team competition will look like in practice.

Some of those will be answered over the next 39 days as football’s biggest tournament unfolds in the United States, Canada and Mexico. Across 104 matches in 16 host cities, teams will navigate vast distances, multiple time zones and varying conditions, testing not only their quality but also endurance.

Argentina enters the showpiece with much of the squad that conquered the world in Qatar and with Lionel Messi still leading the way.

Now 38 and playing for Inter Miami, Messi knows North American conditions better than most rivals and will hope familiarity can fuel one final run at the world stage.

Argentina begins as one of the favourites, but there will be no shortage of challengers. Spain arrives as the reigning European champion, powered by the



Let the action begin: The Mexico City Stadium in readiness for the tournament opener between the co-host and South Africa. GETTY IMAGES

creativity of Pedri and Lamine Yamal. Under Luis de la Fuente, it has evolved beyond the possession-heavy style that defined its golden generation, combining technical excellence with greater intensity and directness.

France, world champion in 2018 and finalist in 2022, has spent much of the last decade setting the benchmark in international football.

Weight of expectations Mbappe, Ousmane Dembele and Aurelien Tchouameni headline a side capable of dominating games with or without possession and adapting to the varied demands of tournament football.

England, led by Jude Bellingham and Harry Kane, will again carry the weight of expectations, while Brazil seeks its first World Cup title since 2002. Germany appears rejuvenated after years of inconsistency, with Portugal hoping Cris-

tiano Ronaldo can inspire one final memorable run.

The tournament’s biggest change is structural. Expansion to 48 teams has altered the landscape of international football.

Asia now has eight direct qualification places and Africa nine, opening the door for nations that previously stood little chance of reaching the World Cup.

Uzbekistan, Cape Verde, Curacao and Jordan will make their debuts, while several emerging football countries believe that they can do more than simply participate. Whether the expanded format strengthens the competition or merely stretches it remains to be seen.

Off the field, at a time when the world feels increasingly fenced off, the game has already encountered some of the complications that come with staging a global event.

Iran will be based in Mexico and commute to its

matches in the United States amid continuing tensions between Tehran and Washington and the wider regional conflict involving Israel.

There has also been controversy surrounding Somali referee Omar Abdulkadir Artan, who was denied entry into the USA despite reportedly holding a valid visa and diplomatic passport. Artan, the 2025 African Referee of the Year, was set to become the first Somali official to take part at a World Cup.

But for all the attention on politics, travel and expansion, the tournament will ultimately be judged by the football it produces. In a world that often feels increasingly fractured, the World Cup remains one of the few occasions capable of making the globe move to a common rhythm.

And for over a month, football, hopefully, will once again prove to be bigger than the machinery that powers it today.

2026 FIFA World Cup in numbers

- A record **48 nations** will take part in the 23rd edition of the FIFA World Cup to be held over 39 days
- **104 matches** will played across 16 cities in three countries (USA, Canada, Mexico)
- **Curacao, Cape Verde, Uzbekistan and Jordan** are making their debut with the first-named being the smallest nation to participate in a World Cup
- The club most represented will be **Manchester City** with 19 players set to feature in the tournament
- **Argentina** will strive to be the third country to defend its title after Italy (1934 & 38) and Brazil (1958 & 62)
- **Lionel Messi**, who has 13 goals, needs four more to become the all-time highest scorer in World Cup history



■ **Messi** (Argentina), **Cristiano Ronaldo** (Portugal) and **Guillermo Ochoa** (Mexico) set for a historic sixth World Cup

days, is the oldest player registered to take part while Mexico’s **Gilberto Mora** (17 years and 240 days) is the youngest

■ Ghana’s **Carlos Queiroz** is coaching at his fifth consecutive World Cup, having guided Portugal in 2010 and Iran in the last three editions

■ France’s **Didier Deschamps** and Uzbekistan’s **Fabio Cannavaro** are two coaches who have tasted success as captains in 1998 and 2006 respectively

■ The 2026 champion will be richer by **\$50 million**, while the runner-up will receive **\$33 million**

COMPILED BY V.V. RAMANAN

The schedule

Date	Teams	Time	Venue
June 12	Mexico vs. South Africa	00.30 a.m.	Mexico City
June 12	South Korea vs. Czechia	7.30 a.m.	Guadalajara
June 13	Canada vs. Bosnia & Herzegovina	00.30 a.m.	Toronto
June 13	USA vs. Paraguay	6.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 14	Qatar vs. Switzerland	00.30 a.m.	San Francisco
June 14	Brazil vs. Morocco	3.30 a.m.	New Jersey
June 14	Haiti vs. Scotland	6.30 a.m.	Boston
June 14	Australia vs. Türkiye	9.30 a.m.	Vancouver
June 14	Germany vs. Curacao	10.30 p.m.	Houston
June 15	Netherlands vs. Japan	1.30 a.m.	Dallas
June 15	Ivory Coast vs. Ecuador	4.30 a.m.	Philadelphia
June 15	Sweden vs. Tunisia	7.30 a.m.	Monterrey
June 15	Spain vs. Cape Verde	9.30 p.m.	Atlanta
June 16	Belgium vs. Egypt	00.30 a.m.	Seattle
June 16	Saudi Arabia vs. Uruguay	3.30 a.m.	Miami
June 16	Iran vs. New Zealand	6.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 17	France vs. Senegal	00.30 a.m.	New Jersey
June 17	Iraq vs. Norway	3.30 a.m.	Boston
June 17	Argentina vs. Algeria	6.30 a.m.	Kansas City
June 17	Austria vs. Jordan	9.30 a.m.	San Francisco
June 17	Portugal vs. DR Congo	10.30 p.m.	Houston
June 18	England vs. Croatia	1.30 a.m.	Dallas
June 18	Ghana vs. Panama	4.30 a.m.	Toronto
June 18	Uzbekistan vs. Colombia	7.30 a.m.	Mexico City
June 18	Czechia vs. South Africa	9.30 p.m.	Atlanta
June 19	Switzerland vs. Bosnia & Herzegovina	00.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 19	Canada vs. Qatar	3.30 a.m.	Vancouver
June 19	Mexico vs. South Korea	6.30 a.m.	Guadalajara
June 20	USA vs. Australia	00.30 a.m.	Seattle
June 20	Scotland vs. Morocco	3.30 a.m.	Boston
June 20	Brazil vs. Haiti	6 a.m.	Philadelphia
June 20	Türkiye vs. Paraguay	8.30 a.m.	San Francisco
June 20	Netherlands vs. Sweden	10.30 p.m.	Houston
June 21	Germany vs. Ivory Coast	1.30 a.m.	Toronto
June 21	Ecuador vs. Curacao	5.30 a.m.	Kansas City
June 21	Tunisia vs. Japan	9.30 a.m.	Monterrey
June 21	Spain vs. Saudi Arabia	9.30 p.m.	Atlanta
June 22	Belgium vs. Iran	00.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 22	Uruguay vs. Cape Verde	3.30 a.m.	Miami
June 22	New Zealand vs. Egypt	6.30 a.m.	Vancouver
June 22	Argentina vs. Austria	10.30 p.m.	Dallas
June 23	France vs. Iraq	2.30 a.m.	Philadelphia
June 23	Norway vs. Senegal	5.30 a.m.	New Jersey
June 23	Jordan vs. Algeria	8.30 a.m.	San Francisco
June 23	Portugal vs. Uzbekistan	10.30 p.m.	Houston
June 24	England vs. Ghana	1.30 a.m.	Boston
June 24	Panama vs. Croatia	4.30 a.m.	Toronto
June 24	Colombia vs. DR Congo	7.30 a.m.	Guadalajara
June 25	Switzerland vs. Canada	00.30 a.m.	Vancouver
June 25	Bosnia & Herzegovina vs. Qatar	00.30 a.m.	Seattle
June 25	Scotland vs. Brazil	3.30 a.m.	Miami
June 25	Morocco vs. Haiti	3.30 a.m.	Atlanta

Date	Teams	Time	Venue
June 25	Czechia vs. Mexico	6.30 a.m.	Mexico City
June 25	South Africa vs. South Korea	6.30 a.m.	Monterrey
June 26	Curacao vs. Ivory Coast	1.30 a.m.	Philadelphia
June 26	Ecuador vs. Germany	1.30 a.m.	New Jersey
June 26	Japan vs. Sweden	4.30 a.m.	Dallas
June 26	Tunisia vs. Netherlands	4.30 a.m.	Kansas City
June 26	Türkiye vs. USA	7.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 26	Paraguay vs. Australia	7.30 a.m.	San Francisco
June 27	Norway vs. France	00.30 a.m.	Boston
June 27	Senegal vs. Iraq	00.30 a.m.	Toronto
June 27	Cape Verde vs. Saudi Arabia	5.30 a.m.	Houston
June 27	Uruguay vs. Spain	5.30 a.m.	Guadalajara
June 27	Egypt vs. Iran	8.30 a.m.	Seattle
June 27	New Zealand vs. Belgium	8.30 a.m.	Vancouver
June 28	Panama vs. England	2.30 a.m.	New Jersey
June 28	Croatia vs. Ghana	2.30 a.m.	Philadelphia
June 28	Colombia vs. Portugal	5 a.m.	Miami
June 28	DR Congo vs. Uzbekistan	5 a.m.	Atlanta
June 28	Algeria vs. Austria	7.30 a.m.	Kansas City
June 28	Jordan vs. Argentina	7.30 a.m.	Dallas
June 29	Round of 32	00.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
June 29	Round of 32	10.30 p.m.	Houston
June 30	Round of 32	2 a.m.	Boston
June 30	Round of 32	6.30 a.m.	Monterrey
June 30	Round of 32	10.30 p.m.	Dallas
July 1	Round of 32	2.30 a.m.	New Jersey
July 1	Round of 32	6.30 a.m.	Mexico City
July 1	Round of 32	9.30 p.m.	Atlanta
July 2	Round of 32	1.30 a.m.	Seattle
July 2	Round of 32	5.30 a.m.	San Francisco
July 3	Round of 32	00.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
July 3	Round of 32	4.30 a.m.	Toronto
July 3	Round of 32	8.30 a.m.	Vancouver
July 3	Round of 32	11.30 p.m.	Dallas
July 4	Round of 32	3.30 a.m.	Miami
July 4	Round of 32	7 a.m.	Kansas City
July 4	Round of 16	10.30 p.m.	Houston
July 5	Round of 16	2.30 a.m.	Philadelphia
July 6	Round of 16	1.30 a.m.	New Jersey
July 6	Round of 16	5.30 a.m.	Mexico City
July 7	Round of 16	00.30 a.m.	Dallas
July 7	Round of 16	5.30 a.m.	Seattle
July 7	Round of 16	9.30 p.m.	Atlanta
July 8	Round of 16	1.30 a.m.	Vancouver
July 10	Quarterfinal	1.30 a.m.	Boston
July 11	Quarterfinal	00.30 a.m.	Los Angeles
July 12	Quarterfinal	2.30 a.m.	Miami
July 12	Quarterfinal	6.30 a.m.	Kansas City
July 15	Semifinal	00.30 a.m.	Dallas
July 16	Semifinal	00.30 a.m.	Atlanta
July 19	Third-place playoff	2.30 a.m.	Miami
July 20	Final	00.30 a.m.	New Jersey

* ALL DATES AND TIMES PERTAIN TO INDIA

The 2022 defeat should inspire France to reach another final

It’s the team that matters the most; I will be the happiest man if we earn the third star

INTERVIEW

Kylian Mbappe

French superstar Kylian Mbappe said that defeat in the 2022 World Cup final should act as motivation going into the upcoming edition. Excerpts:

France is ‘the’ favourite to go the distance. What are your thoughts?

If that happens, everyone will be happy! But in the World Cup, such tags bring nothing. Winning the WC is an extremely difficult job and we must play well. We have an exceptional pool of talented players with



Mbappe. AFP

great appetite. But we must show it on the field.

You can emulate Cafu’s feat of playing in three World Cup finals...

It’s the team that matters the most. I shall be happy if we reach the final. But as I

have said, we must play well to do so. I love to dream, and it will be great to play another World Cup final. However, now, I am not thinking about it.

We have the right squad under a great coach (Didier Deschamps) who had taken us to the final in 2018 and 2022.

This will be the last edition with Deschamps as coach...

Just look at his CV, it speaks volumes about the man. He was the captain when we won our first World Cup (in 1998). Twenty years later, he was again at the podium as the winning manager. We reached another final in four years, a legend in its truest sense!

How disappointing was that night in Qatar?

We had broken hearts; disappointment will be there forever. But we must move on. That defeat should inspire us to play better and reach another final.

You can match or better the goal-scoring records of Pele, Just Fontaine and Miroslav Klose...

You can score more goals than them, but it is impossible to reach their level. I shall be happy if I score one, two or five goals, but I shall be happier if we win the trophy. I will be the happiest man if my team earns the third star. (Professional Management Group).

INBRIEF



T20 WC: India loses final warm-up game to England

Richa Ghosh, *in pic*, produced a breathtaking late assault but Dani Gibson’s sparkling all-round show proved enough as England posted a narrow five-run win in their final Women’s T20 World Cup warm-up match in Cardiff on Wednesday. After Harmanpreet Kaur opted to bowl, Amy Jones, skipper Nat Sciver-Brunt and Gibson took England to 171 for six. India’s chase never quite gathered momentum and it was bowled out for 166 in 19.5 overs.

The scores: England 171/6 in 20 overs (Amy Jones 64, Nat Sciver-Brunt 57, Dani Gibson 30 n.o.; Shreyanka Patil 2/29) bt India 166 in 19.5 overs (Richa Ghosh 68; Linsey Smith 3/42, Charlie Dean 2/16, Tilly Corteen-Coleman 2/22, Dani Gibson 2/17).

Sindhu cruises, Tanvi stuns fifth seed Chiu

P.V. Sindhu led a strong show by Indian women with an easy victory over Peru’s Ines Luci Castillo Salazar while teenager Tanvi Sharma pulled off an upset win over fifth seed and World No. 11 Chiu Pin-Chian of Taiwan at the Australian Open Super 500 badminton tournament in Sydney on Wednesday.

The results (first round): Women: PV. Sindhu bt Ines Luci Castillo Salazar 21-13, 21-11; Tanvi Sharma bt Chiu Pin-Chian 21-12, 22-20; Malvika Bansod bt Tonrug Saeheng 15-21, 21-7, 21-13; Isharani Baruah bt Han Qian Xi 22-20, 10-21, 21-14; Tanya Hemanth bt Ishika Jaiswal 21-17, 21-18; **Men:** Justin Hoh bt Kiran George 19-21, 21-14, 15-21; Hu Zhe’an bt Saneeth Dayanand 21-8, 21-10; Lin Chun-Yi bt Tharun Manneppalli 18-21, 21-13, 25-23. **Mixed doubles:** Dhruv Rawat & Maneesha K. bt Lim Jayden & Victoria Tjonadi 21-13, 21-14; Guo Xin Wa & Chen Fang Hui bt Mohit Jaglan & Lakshita Jaglan 21-6, 21-5.

Hyderabad to host Archery Premier League in October

The second edition of the Archery Premier League (APL) will be held in Hyderabad from October 8 to 18. Several top international archers are expected to take part in the 11-day event to be hosted at the People’s Plaza on Necklace Road. Six franchise teams – Mighty Marathas, Rajputana Royals, Prithiviraaj Yodhas, Kakatiya Knights, Chero Archers and Chola Chiefs – will participate in the APL, which made its debut in Delhi last year.



Benfica says Mourinho has agreed to move to Real

Benfica said on Tuesday that its coach Jose Mourinho had agreed to return to Real Madrid, which earlier announced that it had parted ways with coach Alvaro Arbeloa. Madrid president Florentino Perez had vowed to bring Mourinho back as part of his campaign promises that led to his re-election on Sunday. Benfica said that Madrid had formally agreed to pay Benfica \$17.3 million for Mourinho, with the Portuguese coach agreeing to the move.

Men’s compound archers go down to Mexico

The Indian compound men’s team, comprising Sahil Jadhav, Kushal Dalal, Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru, narrowly lost its bronze medal contest 232-233 to Mexico at the Archery World Cup Stage-3 in Antalya on Wednesday. Mexico’s team consisted of Sebastian Garcia Flores, Lot Maximo Mendez Ortiz and Rodrigo Gonzalez De Alba. In recurve qualification, B. Dhiraj, who shot a season best 681, and Kumkum Mohod, who logged her career best 671, were the best Indians. **The results: Recurve: Qualification: Individual: Men:** B. Dhiraj (6th, 681), Neeraj Chauhan (10th, 677), Atanu Das (67th, 651), Yashdeep Bhoge (84th, 637). **Women:** Kumkum Mohod (3rd, 671), Deepika Kumari (7th, 665), Ankita Bhakat (21st, 653), Kirti (43rd, 642). **Team: India:** Men (7th, 2009), Women (3rd, 1989), Mixed (3rd, 1352). **Compound: Elimination: Team: Men:** India (Sahil Jadhav, Kushal Dalal, Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru) bt Singapore 227-227 (shoot-off: 30-28) (first round), bt Italy 231-231 (shoot-off: 29*-29, shot closer to centre) (quarterfinal), lost to China 232-235 (semifinal), lost to Mexico 232-233 (bronze medal match). **Women:** India (V. Jyothi Surekha, Chikitha Taniparthi, Prithika Pradeep) got a bye (first round), lost to USA 225-228 (second round).

Can the Women in Blue go to uncharted territory?

India cannot afford to look far into the tournament at the moment; it is in the Group of Death along with Australia and South Africa and only two teams can advance to the last four

ICC T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Some images linger. Like Kapil Dev holding the World Cup aloft at the Lord’s balcony in 1983. Like Harmanpreet Kaur teasing her teammates before letting them touch the trophy after the Women’s World Cup final at Mumbai’s D.Y. Patil Stadium last November.

‘Kapil’s Devils’ paved the way for an eventual Indian takeover of the global cricket economy, apart from making the country a superpower on the ground. Harmanpreet’s brave women have given India’s aspiring young female cricketers a moment to cherish, a right to dream.

How Harmanpreet would love to emulate Kapil: win a World Cup at cricket’s most iconic venue. She is unlikely to be satisfied with anything less than that this English summer. India is one of the favourites at the ICC T20 Women’s World Cup starting at Birmingham on Friday. India cannot afford to look far into the tournament at the moment, though. For, they are in the Group of Death, along with Australia and South Africa. Remember, only two teams can advance to the semifinals.

The Women in Blue may have lost their last two



Gunning for glory: Harmanpreet & Co. can’t slip up if they want to go the distance. »@BCCI

T20I series, in South Africa and England, but not so long ago, they had triumphed in Australia and crushed Sri Lanka 5-0. No one will doubt their class, especially in batting.

India, in fact, will need those batters, especially at the top of the order, to get going, play big shots, and come up with significant scores. The team isn’t blessed with the sharpest or the most experienced of bowling attacks in the competition.

Neither it could claim to have a large number of all-rounders, notwithstanding the redoubtable Deepti Sharma. How India misses the chirpy, smiling, wise-cracking Amanjot Kaur, who played an important role in India’s World Cup

win. The superstar-studded Indian batting is more than capable of making enough runs so that the team doesn’t depend too much on the lower order. Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma are among the most feared pair of openers in the game.

Smriti may not be going into the World Cup in perfect form, but her experience and success in England should come in handy. She has sparked at The Hundred and last year scored a 62-ball 112 against England, her first T20I century.

Like Smriti, Jemimah Rodrigues also is familiar with English conditions and she should want to replicate her heroics at the ODI World Cup for India.

Harmanpreet can win you matches from difficult situations, while the return from injury of the elegant Yaskita Bhatia is good news – she impressed in the three-match series against England – but the team needs Richa Ghosh to deliver in the death overs.

When it comes to bowling, Renuka Singh should relish the English conditions. Kranti Goud can cause trouble with her pace, while Nandini Sharma looks extremely promising, with her wicket-taking abilities. Shree Charani, who has taken little time to make an impact on the global stage, Shreyanka Patil and Radha Yadav are among the spin options. And, of course, there is the golden arm of Shafali.

AROUND THE CITY



Young champs: The winners of the first State-ranking table tennis tournament. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Anuraag and Mukilesh sizzle on opening day Debutant and captain Anuraag Rajesh Nair led from the front with an unbeaten 122 as Swaraj CC reached 236 for eight against Grand Slam on the opening day of the TNCA first division league for the 2026-27 season on Wednesday. U. Mukilesh roared for Singam Puli with a knock of 156, but the team lost the plot and was bowled out for 268 against Nelson.

The scores (first round): At Gojan-B: Swaraj 236/8 in 90 overs (Ramnath 31, Anuraag Rajesh Nair 122 batting) vs. Grand Slam; **Toss:** Slam. **At A.M. Jain:** Young Stars 265/4 in 90 overs (M. Mithul Raj 139 batting, Aditty Varadharajan 78, A. Badrinda 30) vs. MRC-A; **Toss:** MRC-A. **At MRF-Pachaiyappa’s:** Globe Trotters 217/9 in 90 overs (D. Santhosh Kumar 42, G. Ajitesh 51, R. Srinivasan 34 batting, M.E. Yazh Arun Mozhi 3/35, N.S. Harish 3/59) vs. Pristine; **Toss:** Trotters. **At RKM-Vivekananda:** SKM 273/9 in 93 overs (M. Affan Khader 59, J. Kousik 106 batting, V. Maaruthi Raghav 49, N. Selvakumaran 3/73) vs. Sea Hawks; **Toss:** SKM. **At CSK-Guru Nanak:** Jolly Rovers 71 in 24.4 overs (K. Om Nitin 4/12, Gurjapneet Singh 3/22) vs. Vijay 215/4 in 53 overs (K.T.A. Madhava Prasad 60, Pradosh Ranjan Paul 39, Nidhish S. Rajagopal 80 batting); **Toss:** Vijay. **At Nelson-Wahe Guru-A:** Singam Puli 268 in 71.2 overs (U. Mukilesh 156, R. Ram Arvindh 46, Sachin Rathi 4/93, R. Sanjay Yadav 4/63) vs Nelson 46/2 in 13 overs; **Toss:** Nelson.



(U. Mukilesh (Singam Puli, 156), Anuraag Rajesh Nair (Swaraj 122 batting).



M. Mithul Raj (Young Stars, 139 batting), J. Kousik (SKM CC 106 batting).

Tharun, Selena Deepti emerge champions S. Tharun and Selena Deepti, both from Raman Table Tennis High Performance Centre (RTTHPC), clinched the men’s and women’s titles in the first State-ranking table tennis tournament. **The results: Finals: Men:** S. Tharun (RTTHPC) bt K. Umesh (RTTHPC) 11-8, 8-11, 11-7, 4-11, 12-10, 15-13. **Boys: U-19:** S. Sriram (Chennai Achievers) bt M. Mohammed (SK Academy) 11-8, 12-10, 8-11, 11-4, 10-12, 14-12; **U-17:** M. Mohammed (SK Academy) bt Akshay Bhushan (Chennai) 11-9, 5-11, 8-11, 11-6, 14-12; **U-15:** Sanjay Arwindh (SK Academy) bt M. Ashvajith (SK Academy) 11-9, 9-11, 6-11, 11-9, 12-10; **U-13:** R. Sujeth (Bestshot TTA) bt K.A. Prashnav Balaji (Madurai) 11-6, 11-4, 12-10; **U-11:** Akhil Vinodh (Vinwin) bt T.K. Akshath (Dronacharya TTA) 1-11, 11-6, 11-4, 11-5; **U-9:** S. Advhik (MAK Chandra) bt Divit Jain (SK Academy) 11-6, 11-9, 3-11, 12-10. **Women:** Selena Deepti (RTTHPC) bt S. Yashini (SK Academy) 11-9, 11-5, 11-9, 8-11, 6-11, 10-12, 11-5.



Memorable: The victorious SRM IST men’s basketball team.

Girls: U-19: B.R. Nandhini (MVM) bt R. Mercy (ACE TTA) 8-11, 11-9, 13-11, 11-7, 11-8; **U-17:** R. Mercy (ACE TTA) bt O.P. Poojaasri (Himalaya TTA) 11-4, 5-11, 11-7, 11-4; **U-15:** Chinthananya Nandagopal (Dronacharya TTA) bt A. Bavithra (LCC-Neyveli) 12-10, 9-11, 11-2, 13-11; **U-13:** N. Sahana (Bestshot TTA) bt V.G. Harshika (Madurai) 11-6, 11-7, 11-8; **U-11:** H. Dhiya (Bestshot TTA) bt K.P. Narumugai (ITTC) 11-8, 11-2, 11-9; **U-9:** N. Yanthi (Cbe) bt Sharadha Ramakrishnan (MST) 10-12, 11-3, 8-11, 12-10, 11-8; **Corporate:** J. Arunkumar (Chennai) bt Prasanna Kumar (SK Academy) 11-6, 11-6, 11-8; **Veterans:** G. Vinodh (SRSA) bt R. Rajesh (LIC) 8-11, 11-7, 11-6, 10-12, 11-9.

Anish, Hiya triumph L. Lara Anish and Hiya Arvindhan clinched the under-18 boys’ and girls’ titles in a tournament organised by Chengalpattu District Carrom Association in association with Ashish Sports Club and Nanganallur Carrom Academy, recently.

The winners: U-18: Boys: L. Lara Anish bt M. Nithen 23-0, 17-13, 21-0; **Girls:** Hiya Arvindhan bt V. Tina Nithila 19-8, 19-10; **Open doubles:** V. Aakash & Joe Louis bt S. Anandhan & M. Dhanasekhar 25-1, 19-15.

SRM IST men win SRM IST won the State-level ‘B’ Grade ball badminton men’s

tournament, organised by King Star BBC, in Madurai recently. St. Joseph’s EC was second while AR Hospital (Chennai) finished third.

SRMIST signs MoU with SRSA SRM Institute of Science and Technology has entered into a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Southern Railway Sports Association (SRSA), according to a release from SRMIST on Tuesday. The MoU seeks to establish a framework for co-operation in the areas of athlete training, sports infrastructure utilisation, talent identification, coaching development, sports science research, knowledge exchange, organisation of sporting events, and community engagement programme.

SPR to take on Omega SPR CA will meet Omega SA in the final of the Master Cricket club Summer Cup u-13 inter-academy cricket tournament.

The scores (semifinals): St. Joseph CA 147/9 in 30 overs (Mukund 37, Kocharaan 3/ 26) lost to SPR Cricket Academy 151/7 in 28.2 overs (Rudra Rasheen 30, Suhaani 53).



SNAPSHOTS

Hardik ruled out of Afghanistan ODIs

NEW CHANDIGARH: Cleared to play just hours ago, India all-rounder Hardik Pandya was on Wednesday ruled out of the three-match ODI series against Afghanistan after picking up a quadriceps strain. Hardik was at the BCCI’s Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru to get clearance for his back spasm injury which he sustained in the IPL.

Stokes and Atkinson get the axe

LONDON: England captain Ben Stokes and teammate Gus Atkinson have been dropped from the squad for next week’s second Test against New Zealand at the Oval, the England and Wales Cricket Board announced on Wednesday. The pair is currently facing an ECB probe for breaking a team curfew following England’s win in the first Test at Lord’s. Joe Root will step in as

interim captain in Stokes’s absence.

“The England & Wales Cricket Board can confirm that, given the ongoing investigation, Ben Stokes and Gus Atkinson have not been made available for selection for the Rothesay second Test against New Zealand, which starts at the Kia Oval on Wednesday 17 June,” said an ECB statement.

“Yorkshire batter Joe Root will lead the team as interim captain. Sussex fast bowler Jofra Archer and Essex batter Jordan Cox have been added to the squad.”

The ECB announced on Monday it was looking into Stokes’ involvement in a nightclub incident also involving Saracens rugby player Toota Auvaa on Monday morning following England’s 115-run win in the first Test at Lord’s.

A physical confrontation with Auvaa is understood to have led to a member of ECB security staff being struck.



Sandeep (Chengalpattu, 6/48).

Tiruvallur and Chengalpattu through

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Tiruvallur and Chengalpattu advanced to the quarter-finals of the TNCA inter-district u-19 tournament on Wednesday.

At Chengalpattu: Chengalpattu 188 in 83.2 overs & 85/2 in 18 overs (Thejeshwar Ganesh 45) drew with Tiruchi 149 in 56.4 overs (P.G. Mithun Raaj 43, M. Thusuvanthi Sri 30 n.o., B. Sandeep 6/48). *Chengalpattu took the first-innings lead & advanced to the quarterfinals.* **At Tiruvallur:** Tenkasi 96 in 45.2 overs & 85/3 in 17 overs (J. Allen 36) drew with Tiruvallur 350/9 decl. in 89.4 overs (K.P. Thaswin Kumar 79, M. Mohith Singh 80, R. Sohan Pushparaj 74). *Tiruvallur took the first-innings lead and advanced.*

Manav signs up to play for Warwickshire

Press Trust of India
LONDON

Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar, who starred on his India Test debut against Afghanistan, has signed up with English club Warwickshire for the next two rounds of the County Championship. He will be available for the game against Yorkshire in Scarborough from June 12 and the fixture against Somerset the following week.

LIVE TELECAST

Tri-series: Afghanistan-A vs India-A: Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10 a.m.

Football: World Cup, Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & 25 App, 12.30 a.m. (Friday)

West Indies vs Sri Lanka: 1st T20I, FanCode, 6 a.m. (Friday)

Separation season

The Monaco GP revealed a title contender struggling to halt a slide. It revealed a seven-time World champion growing ever more comfortable in red, and a home-town hero searching desperately for answers



Anirudh Velamuri

Mercedes emerged as the clear front runner when this F1 season began, having nailed the new regulations and building a car capable of setting it on the path of dominance this campaign, and maybe more.

Ferrari showed early promise but was soon clear that it had the second-best car on the grid, though it remained capable of causing headaches to the Silver Arrows. Mercedes team principal Toto Wolff acknowledged that after the season-opening Australian Grand Prix, saying, “The prevailing feeling is that we now have a fight on our hands with Ferrari.”

The two teams have been the strongest ones so far, but the gap between the two isn’t as miniscule as the neutral would’ve wanted. At last weekend’s Monaco GP, however, both went through similar emotions with their drivers, at contrasting levels.

Anatomy of dominance

Unlike many - perhaps most - other circuits on the F1 calendar, the Monaco GP is rarely decided by wheel-to-wheel combat. Around those unforgiving, narrow streets, track position is king. Precision outweighs aggression, and the smallest mistake can carry the biggest consequences.

The formula for success is almost deceptively simple: produce the lap of your life in qualifying, start near the front, keep the car out of trouble, and make sure no one jumps you during the pit-stop cycle. It is why Formula 1’s oldest joke remains one of its truest: “Monaco is won on Saturday.”

Yet, Monaco has always been more than a procession. To purists, it is the ultimate examination of a driver’s craft. A qualifying lap around the Principality is often described as the purest expression of speed, commitment, and precision that motorsport can offer.

That much remained true this year. But there was another layer to the story.

Was the Mercedes W17 exceptional? Absolutely. Did pole position pave the way for victory? Without question. But Kimi Antonelli’s commanding triumph in Monaco - his fifth consecutive win of the season - was anything but a textbook Monaco success.

He did not merely protect track position. He annihilated the contest.

When the lights went out, Antonelli launched into clear air and never looked back. The task became significantly easier when Max Verstappen’s Red Bull, which had qualified within four-hundredths of a second of the Mercedes, retired on the opening lap. Antonelli seized the opportunity with ruthless efficiency.

By lap four, he had already carved out a healthy margin to the chasing pack. His only real companion during the long afternoon at the front was race engineer Pete Bonnington, whose occasional radio messages punctuated an otherwise lonely drive. There were reminders about tyre temperatures still running a touch high, cautions to manage brake temperatures while negotiating traffic, and little else.

The race quickly shifted from attack to control. By lap nine, Antonelli’s advantage was already substantial enough to allow a greater focus on management. The gap

stretched relentlessly, reaching 15 seconds by the time Lewis Hamilton made his pit stop. When Charles Leclerc took fresh tyres, Antonelli responded, rejoining comfortably in the lead and maintaining complete control of proceedings.

He was serenely cruising toward victory when Monaco finally delivered a hint of drama.

A late safety car erased what had grown into a lead of nearly half a minute. Then came a red flag, introducing an element of uncertainty that had been absent all afternoon. A standing restart loomed. Ferrari, whose cars had shown impressive launch performance, suddenly had a narrow window of opportunity through Hamilton.

For a brief moment, there was at least the possibility of a fight. It lasted only a few corners. When racing resumed for what effectively became an eight-lap sprint to the chequered flag, Antonelli immediately reasserted his authority. He surged clear once more, rebuilt a comfortable advantage, and extinguished any lingering hopes of a Ferrari challenge.

The final laps felt less like a battle for victory and more like a coronation.

And as he swept through the streets of the Principality for the final time, Antonelli did more than win the Monaco GP. He etched his name into the history of one of motorsport’s most iconic stages.

The safety car came. The red flag came. The possibility of a late fight briefly flickered into life. But Monaco’s script had already been written. Antonelli did not spend Sunday defending a lead; he spent it demonstrating why nobody else deserved it.

On a circuit where victory is supposed to reward perfection over pace, patience over daring, Antonelli delivered something a little rarer: domination. By the time he reached the chequered flag, the result was no longer the story. The manner of it was.

Disintegration on the other side

If the Principality became the stage for a defining statement for Antonelli, it marked the latest chapter in an increasingly troubling slide on the other side of his garage for George Russell.

While Antonelli disappeared into the distance, Russell spent much of his afternoon trapped in fifth place behind a struggling Isack Hadjar. Despite the Red Bull driver’s issues, he still managed to put 20 seconds between himself and the Mercedes, leaving Russell vulnerable to the ultimate indignity around Monaco: being lapped by his teammate. Sure enough, after 53 laps, Antonelli swept past him.

Things only unravelled from there. Mercedes failed to react quickly enough to the safety car triggered by Lance Stroll, opting not to pit Antonelli immediately. The resulting sequence left Russell stacked behind the championship leader when he eventually stopped, costing him the position he had only just wrestled away from Hadjar.

And then came the final blow.

Russell was then hit with a drive-through penalty that had to be served after the late restart when the field was tightly packed together. Any hope of salvaging something from the weekend evaporated there and then. He eventually crossed the line in 14th place, and now finds himself trailing Antonelli by 68

points. Suzuka qualifying was a gut punch. Retiring from the lead in Montreal was arguably worse. Yet somehow, Monaco may prove the most damaging weekend of all.

Not simply because of the result, but because of what Russell is now saying about it. “There’s something in my driving style that’s not helping the car at the moment but is playing into his hands perfectly well. The difference in how we’re driving has such an impact upon the tyres,” he admitted after qualifying.

Heading into this season, Russell was the driver bookmakers expected to dominate the title fight. Now, he is not only no longer leading it, he is not even Antonelli’s closest challenger. That distinction belongs to Hamilton, who leapfrogged his fellow Brit into second place after Monaco.

A few months ago, Russell looked like Mercedes’ title favourite. Today, he looks like a driver searching for answers while the championship rapidly slips out of reach.

A tale of two, for Ferrari too

Divided emotions were not confined to Mercedes.

Ferrari arrived in Monaco looking capable of mounting a genuine challenge, and for a brief moment it seemed as though the Scuderia might have the pace to do exactly that. Hamilton and Charles Leclerc, fresh off signing a contract extension, were untouchable in Friday’s opening session and, while the field closed in during the afternoon, Ferrari still ended the day on top.

From there, however, the trajectory was almost entirely downward.

Hamilton outqualified Leclerc after the Monegasque brushed the barriers at Tabac on his final Q3 attempt. What followed was not merely a divergence in results, but in mood, confidence and outlook. As Ferrari’s weekend slipped away, an increasingly technical debate over brake performance began to dominate the conversation.

By then, the contrast in the drivers’ own words was clear.

“The happiest day of my Ferrari days so far. I finally have the engineering team that I’ve been working towards. I think our car is great. I can understand it and am a lot more comfortable with it. While we’re not exactly where we want to be, getting this result has capitalised on our great reliability. I feel very light right now, mentally in a good place,” Hamilton said after the Canadian GP.

Leclerc, meanwhile, could hardly have sounded more different.

“It’s been one of, if not the, worst weekend of my career. I have work to do to get to Lewis’s level on a day like this. I will look into the data. I’ve gone through difficult races [before] where you analyse after and you learn a lot,” he then admitted. The gap between the two has not simply been one of results. It has increasingly become a story of differing solutions to similar, if not the same, problem.

Hamilton switched to customised brake packages supplied by Carbon Industrie at Suzuka, favouring a stronger initial bite and more precise modulation that complements his trademark late-braking style.

Leclerc, meanwhile, has continued with Brembo hardware. Given his

preference for an aggressive front end, a higher tolerance for oversteer, and a tendency to brake earlier than Hamilton, the setup has become an increasingly frustrating limitation.

By Monaco, that frustration had boiled over. “I don’t know how much I can go into the details, but I don’t think... it’s just not acceptable. The issues I have faced with my brakes have been...it’s not that it’s difficult, it’s that in this particular moment, it’s just impossible,” the Monegasque said after his home race.

His description of the problem was even more revealing.

“I cannot do anything. The only thing I can do is not brake for the last corner, but in an F1 corner not braking in the last corner ends up in the wall anyway. I put the least amount of brakes I could possibly do, and it’s not even braking, it’s leaning my foot on the brake.”

When asked to elaborate on the root cause, Leclerc stopped just short of publicly pointing the finger at Ferrari’s long-time brake supplier. “I think it’s very clear for everyone, I don’t think there’s any doubt.”

That was enough to prompt a swift response from Brembo.

“At present, the company does not know the causes of the issues experienced by Charles Leclerc and therefore considers it premature to draw definitive technical conclusions before the available data has been analysed,” the company said.

“In cases such as this, it is necessary to examine the telemetry data together with the team’s engineers in order to accurately determine the origin of the incident.”

Whether Brembo ultimately bears responsibility may be irrelevant, for Leclerc has already identified the direction he wants Ferrari to take.

“The only thing I can say is that we have the solution in-house, and I’ll go to Lewis’s configuration from the next race onwards, which hopefully will be a step,” he revealed, before adding, “But it’s been a nightmare.”

Leclerc’s miserable home weekend cannot be pinned solely on one component, and he has acknowledged as much. Yet the brake saga has become impossible to ignore, not least because a potential remedy already appears to exist within Ferrari’s own garage.

If Hamilton’s configuration transforms his fortunes, Ferrari may look back on Monaco as the weekend that stopped the bleeding.

Subplots thicken

Monaco is often described as F1’s ultimate test. Not because it produces the best racing, but because it exposes every strength, every weakness and every crack beneath the surface.

This year, it exposed plenty. It revealed a young driver turning dominance into routine. It revealed a title contender struggling to halt a slide. It revealed a seven-time world champion growing ever more comfortable in red, and a hometown hero searching desperately for answers.

The championship order may not have changed dramatically, as Mercedes remains the benchmark and Ferrari remains its closest pursuer. But perceptions did. And in F1, perception has a habit of becoming reality.

THE GIST

Monaco is often described as F1’s ultimate test. Not because it produces the best racing, but because it exposes every strength, every weakness and every crack beneath the surface

Antonelli did more than win the Monaco GP. He etched his name into the history of one of motorsport’s most iconic stages

The championship order may not have changed dramatically as Mercedes remains the benchmark and Ferrari remains the closest pursuer

No ‘obesity gene’: your genetic makeup is not a fixed destiny

Scientists cannot reliably predict whether an individual carrying certain gene variants will eventually end up obese; put another way, there is no ‘obesity gene’, and for similar reasons, there is no ‘fat gene’, ‘lazy gene’ or ‘hunger gene’. genetics is also only one part of the story behind diseases

Sayantan Datta

In a 1983 paper, Harvard University geneticists James Gusella and Nancy Wexler reported that Huntington’s disease, a fatal inherited disease where brain cells progressively decay, was caused by a gene mutation on chromosome 4. This was the first time a single gene had been implicated in a disease.

Since then, scientists have discovered about 5,000 genes whose mutations can increase our susceptibility to afflictions ranging from obesity to schizophrenia, and bipolar disorder.

Concomitant with the rise in genetic discoveries is the rise of commercial genetic testing. The U.S.-based company 23andMe, for example, offers a saliva-based test priced at around ₹20,000 that promises “insights into [people’s] ancestry, traits and health that can help make it easier for [them] to take action on [their] health.”

Similarly, Hyderabad-based MapMyGenome offers a “Genomepatri” service for ₹5,999. A play on *janampatri*, a Vedic birth chart purporting to forecast a person’s destiny, Genomepatri offers to help consumers uncover their “authentic self” and enhance their health, according to their website.

But according to six geneticists this reporter spoke to, an individual’s genetic composition is not their destiny.

“Mutations in our genes predispose us to specific traits and diseases, but it doesn’t mean that if you have a mutation, you’re going to get this disease,” Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Hyderabad, molecular geneticist Manish Jaiswal said.

What then does it mean to find a gene for a trait or disease – and what happens when we carry them?

Genes, mutations, disease

Genes are segments of DNA that provide the body a blueprint for building proteins, which eventually help define traits like eye colour or blood type.

When cells in our body divide, specialised proteins make copies of the DNA. This process, while largely accurate, can introduce errors in the duplicated DNA. These changes are called mutations and the corresponding gene is said to have an allele – a variant.

Only a small fraction of an organism’s genome – which is the entire length of its DNA – has genes that its body uses to build proteins. For human beings, this coding region comprises about 2% of the genome. The rest of the DNA is non-coding, i.e. not involved in producing proteins, but regulates gene expression.

If a mutation in the coding region impairs the protein product, it may lead to a disease. For example, in Huntington’s disease, a small section of the *HTT* gene is repeated more times than in an average individual. This produces a longer version of the protein, whose toxic fragments accumulate in brain cells and eventually kill them. As brain cells continue to die, people begin showing symptoms of the disease.

Sometimes, mutations in non-coding regions of the DNA can also change an individual’s risk of a disease. For example, four independent studies in 2007 found that mutations in a particular non-coding region of the DNA were associated with a higher risk of coronary artery disease and type 2 diabetes. Later, in 2011, researchers found that the region contained certain enhancers, short DNA sequences that boost the expression of certain genes.

Identifying genes

To identify genes associated with a trait or disease, scientists until recently took two kinds of approaches: candidate-gene studies and linkage studies.

In candidate-gene studies, scientists use existing information about the disease to identify potential gene candidates that, when mutated, may lead to the disease. For example, because schizophrenia is treated with drugs that regulate the amount of dopamine in the human brain, scientists assumed until 2007 that mutations in genes related to dopamine regulation were linked to schizophrenia.

While such studies were successful in some cases, like Alzheimer’s disease, in others they could not reliably identify genes associated with the disease. In the case of schizophrenia, for example, 21 of 25 candidate genes scientists historically studied were found to have little “empirical support ... as genetic risk factors for schizophrenia,” a 2015 review in *Molecular Psychiatry* reported.

Linkage studies on the other hand begin by identifying a population or a



Genetic tests should always be followed by genetic counselling. Genetic counsellors are specialists who help people assess their risk of developing genetic disorders and help manage them. GETTY IMAGES

family where the incidence of a trait or disease is particularly high. Then, scientists study how known markers in their DNA are inherited. If members of the population carrying the trait or disease also inherit the same markers, scientists can claim that the gene variant responsible for the disease and the marker are close on the chromosome, i.e. they are linked. By using statistical techniques, scientists can then pinpoint the gene.

This method works well when diseases are caused by mutations in one or a few genes, National Institute for Mental Health and Neuro Sciences (NIMHANS) genetics researcher Jayant Mahadevan said. Such diseases, like Huntington’s, are called monogenic when their risk is determined by mutations in one gene and oligogenic when it’s determined by mutations in a few genes.

However, most monogenic diseases are rare: they occur in less than 1% of the population, Dr. Mahadevan added. Most common diseases, including diabetes, obesity, coronary artery disease, and schizophrenia, are polygenic: they are determined by mutations in several genes.

For example, mutations in more than a 100 genes have been implicated in typical obesity. For type 2 diabetes, the most common form of the disease, recent studies place the number at approximately 250 genes. For schizophrenia, scientists suggest that the number could run into several hundreds.

In order to identify gene variants responsible for such diseases, researchers now typically undertake genome-wide association studies (GWAS). By comparing entire DNA sequences of a large number of individuals who carry a disease with that of individuals who don’t, scientists can identify hundreds of variations associated with the disease through the entire length of an individual’s DNA. This gives researchers a more holistic picture of the gene variations underlying the disease.

No ‘obesity gene’

But possessing one or more gene variants implicated in a disease does not mean that one is doomed.

For one, not all gene mutations implicated in a disease have the same effect size. This is a measure of how strongly a gene variant can affect a trait. For example, most gene variants implicated in schizophrenia are thought to have small effect sizes: for an individual’s schizophrenia risk to increase substantially, they need to have mutations in several of these genes.

Studies have shown similar results in the case of gene variants associated with obesity. In a 2010 study, scientists studied the effect sizes of 12 implicated. These



Mutations in our genes predispose us to specific traits and diseases, but it doesn’t mean that if you have a mutation, you’re going to get this disease

MANISH JAISWAL
Molecular geneticist at Tata Institute of Fundamental Research

have “small effects on obesity measures,” they reported. Even mutations in the *FTO* gene, known to have the largest effect on an individual’s obesity risk and is commonly dubbed the “obesity gene”, predisposes a person to only a modest increase in weight compared with individuals who do not carry these mutations, the study added.

Even though a combination of mutations in these genes could compound the risk, “their predictive value for obesity risk is limited,” the researchers concluded.

This means scientists cannot reliably predict whether an individual carrying these gene variants will eventually end up obese. Put another way, there is no “obesity gene”. And for similar reasons, there is no “fat gene”, “lazy gene” or “hunger gene”.

Genetics is also only one part of the story behind a certain disease. The other part is epigenetics: a that refers to how physical, behavioural, and social factors affect the gene expression and, eventually, an individual’s risk of a disease.

“Think of the genome as a piano, where each key represents a gene,” said epigenetics researcher Ullas Kolthur-Seetharam, director of the Centre for DNA Fingerprinting and Diagnostics, Hyderabad, and a professor at the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Mumbai. “If a key is faulty, it can produce discordant notes – reflecting a potential disease risk. However, the system has flexibility: by adjusting how other keys are played, you can often compensate and still produce harmonious music.”

“In the case of certain inherited diseases caused by critical mutations, some keys may be so impaired that no amount of adjustment can fully restore the intended melody,” he added.

“In those situations, the limitation lies in the instrument itself. But for many complex conditions/diseases, how the piano is played (or how the genes are expressed) become as important as the keys themselves.”

Indeed, behavioural and lifestyle interventions can actually reduce the risk of diseases. There is mounting evidence that in individuals with *FTO* variants that increase their risk of obesity,

high-intensity exercise can reduce the gene’s expression, potentially attenuating their risk of developing obesity. One 2015 study that investigated about 16,000 children and adolescents also found that “lower dietary protein intake attenuates the association between the *FTO* genotype and adiposity [the way fat is distributed] in children and adolescents.”

Merits of genetic testing

In this context, what does it mean when scientists report identifying a new gene variant for a disease or a trait?

“All you’ve discovered is its pattern of occurrence in the population or the pattern of its transmission in a family,” NIMHANS senior professor Sanjeev Jain, who works on the genetics of several neurological and psychiatric disorders, explained.

But figuring out whether the variant corresponds to the actual disease – and by how much – requires scientists to undertake more research involving diverse model systems, he added.

This doesn’t mean genetic pursuit is itself useless, both Dr. Jain and Dr. Mahadevan cautioned. Genetic studies do help researchers identify the physiological mechanisms underlying a disease, which can help clinicians design more effective therapeutics. Scientists also often end up finding gene variants that are actually beneficial.

Starting in the 2000s, researchers discovered that some mutations in the *PCSK9* gene can drastically reduce the risk of coronary artery disease. Since then, clinicians have developed ways to silence the gene, thus reducing patients’ cholesterol levels and mitigating the risk of stroke and heart attacks.

Some scientists also see merit in genetic testing – but only in certain contexts. Dimple Notani, a gene regulation researcher at the National Centre for Biological Sciences, Bengaluru, said women who conceive late could consider getting themselves screened for mutations linked to rare genetic disorders, which are often monogenic. But for traits that are not monogenic, “I wouldn’t worry much,” she added.

Genetic tests should always be followed by genetic counselling, Dr. Jaiswal, the TIFR Hyderabad geneticist, said. Genetic counsellors are specialists who help people assess their risk of developing genetic disorders, and help manage them.

In other words, genetics provides us with a helpful but incomplete picture. Between a mutation and its manifestation is a far messier story.

The reporter thanks Dr. Suhas Ganesh (NIMHANS) for his inputs.

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A colourful fence sports an axolotl mascot of the FIFA World Cup in Mexico City. REUTERS

World Cup’s mascot axolotl nowhere in Mexico City

Reuters

One of the first things visitors arriving in Mexico City for the FIFA football World Cup are likely to see is the wide grin of an axolotl – with the salamander unique to this part of the world splashed in bright purple on murals and subway cars or depicted in sculptures dribbling a soccer ball.

Named after the Nahuatl word for “water monster”, the axolotl (pronounced ah-sho-LO-tul) has become the unofficial mascot as the city gears up to host five World Cup matches.

But despite the undoubted cuteness of the almost otherworldly axolotl, the use of its image has drawn backlash from many Mexico City residents, who say the peppy portrayal of the critically endangered animal is being used to distract from both the infrastructure problems of the capital and its lack of conservation efforts.

Scientists trying to count axolotls in the wild say they have not seen a single one in two years. The Mexico City government did not respond to requests for comment.

Along with the constant flow of poorly treated wastewater, fresh dangers to the axolotl include chinampas being turned into soccer pitches and overcrowding due to ecological tourism

Ernesto Velazquez, 19, who runs an axolotl-themed stand selling cuddly toys in Chapultepec park, said he hopes the newly painted images around the city can drive more interest in conservation.

“Some foreigners have asked if you can eat them – well no, they’re at risk of extinction,” he said. “I hope the World Cup will help people learn more so we take better care of them.”

A disappearing habitat

For centuries, *Ambystoma mexicanum*, an amphibian that remains living in water through its life cycle, thrived between chinampas – farms built on human-made floating islands that once sustained the Aztec capital of Tenochtitlan, where modern-day Mexico City lies.

The lake the city was built on was largely drained during colonial rule and its remnants are being used up and contaminated by the growing urban sprawl. But the city’s southern Xochimilco district, known for its maze of mucky canals, remains one of the axolotl’s last hiding places.

UNAM, Mexico’s top university, identified around 36 axolotls per sq. km in Xochimilco in 2014 – a steep drop from the 6,000 per sq. km in 1998. The latest census began in 2024, and, two years later, researchers have yet to find a single axolotl.

Soccer and mass tourism

Luis Zambrano, who heads UNAM’s ecological restoration laboratory, said that besides a constant flow of poorly treated wastewater, fresh dangers to the axolotl include chinampas being turned into soccer pitches and the overcrowding of what began as ecological tourism.

Axolotls consume oxygen through their skin, making them highly vulnerable to water pollution.

“Mass tourism has become a terrible problem now with the World Cup,” said Zambrano. “The government thinks more is better, but that’s not true in these areas of high ecological value.”

Even as their habitat disappears, axolotls are widely bred in captivity. Scientists believe their unique skin mucus and ability to regrow limbs and even parts of their brain offer promising leads in cancer research.

For Zambrano, the axolotls’ viral popularity has yet to translate into concrete action that could save their home.



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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Japanese people who signed online petition against Trump

20,000 Thousands of people have signed an online petition in Japan protesting against U.S. President Donald Trump using manga and anime characters. The petition was re-opened as an urgent effort to convey fans' concerns to rights holders after a new video depicting Mr. Trump as ninja Naruto Uzumaki. AFP

Challans issued in anti-encroachment and parking drive

55,532 These challans were issued against motorists and violators obstructing roads during a week-long anti-encroachment and unauthorised parking drive conducted by Delhi Traffic Police between June 1 and June 7. The drive covered 144 locations across Delhi in coordination with the MCD. PTI

Cong.-approved bill funding immigration crackdown in U.S.

70 in \$ billion. President Donald Trump's headline immigration crackdown for the rest of his term was passed by the U.S. Congress. The measure provides around \$38 billion for Immigration and Customs Enforcement, \$26 billion for Border Patrol and \$5 billion for unforeseen costs, ensuring steady funding for Mr. Trump's deportation agenda through fiscal 2029. AFP

Jump in China's passenger car exports year-on-year in May

73 in per cent. More than eight lakh passenger cars were exported by China in May, a 73% jump year-on-year, as higher gasoline and diesel prices due to the war in Iran raised global interest in electric vehicles. Exports of pure EVs and plug-in hybrids more than doubled to about 435,000 units, accounting for more than half of total exports. AP

Contract signed for GNSS jammers procurement for Navy

449 in ₹ crore. This contract was signed by the Defence Ministry with Accord Software and Systems Private Limited, Bengaluru, for the procurement of 20 enhanced capability Global Navigation Satellite System jammers for the Indian Navy. It was inked in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh. PTI
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The reality behind falling net FDI

India's net FDI has declined sharply despite strong gross inflows, underlining the impact of disinvestment/capital repatriation; investor classes, modes of entry, and exit strategies can have important implications for technology transfer, industrial development, and external sustainability

ECONOMIC NOTES

K.S. Chalapati Rao
Biswajit Dhar
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India's net foreign direct investment (FDI) has declined drastically in recent years. Critics see the weak net flows as a sign of weakness, while the Chief Economic Adviser points to the large inflows and rising manufacturing FDI as evidence of strength. He links weak net flows to profit repatriation and outward investment by Indian companies.

However, this debate overlooks a major issue. By focusing on overall numbers, both sides ignore the changing composition of international capital and the Balance of Payments (BoP) mechanisms that govern inflows and outflows.

For BoP purposes, net FDI is calculated as the difference between inflows and outflows after adjusting for the repatriation of capital. From the peak of \$44.0 billion in 2020-21, net FDI fell to less than \$1 billion in 2024-25. It recovered to \$7.6 billion in 2025-26. The corresponding gross inflow was \$94.6 billion.

It is necessary to note that India's liberal FDI policy, introduced in 1991, initially emphasised technology acquisition, export promotion, and foreign exchange conservation. Over time, policy increasingly prioritised attracting larger inflows, while concerns regarding future external payment obligations and investment quality receded.

Three types of FDI

FDI is often viewed as a uniform, long-term commitment that brings technology and management skills to the host country. FDI can fall into three different investor classes, each with distinct capabilities, strategies, and exit timelines.

The first category is real FDI (RFDI), consisting of traditional multinational enterprises with the technology, brands, and capabilities to establish production and services. These generally represent long-term commitments.

The second category comprises financial investors, including private equity funds, venture capital firms, sovereign wealth funds, and asset managers. Their main goal is capital growth and planned exits.

The third category includes diaspora investments and special purpose vehicles (SPVs). These involve capital raised abroad and funneled through offshore financial centres, sometimes including the round-tripping of Indian funds.

Data on remittance-level FDI from the past four years, from 2022-23 to 2025-26 up to December, show that RFDI made up 41.9% of "effective inflows." Financial investors followed closely with a 40.5% share, while the remaining 17.6% came from the diaspora and SPVs linked to India.

The business model of financial investors suggests future exits that result in large-scale capital repatriations. A notable example occurred in 2025 when Singapore's Temasek exited Schneider Electric India Ltd., earning \$6.4 billion on an investment of \$637 million made in 2020. Total recorded divestment in CY 2025 was \$52 billion, with 45 major foreign private equity and venture capital exits accounting for \$29 billion in outflows.

Based on an analysis of effective



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inflows, FDI in India's manufacturing sector has declined across three consecutive four-year periods. Most notably, RFDI into manufacturing accounted for only 10.6% of total effective inflows during the most recent four-year period.

Not fresh capital

A major blind spot in gross FDI figures is the mixing of new capital injections with corporate accounting changes, such as intra-group ownership reorganisations, mergers, share swaps, and the conversion of earlier non-equity instruments such as external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and convertible debentures.

While capital structures change, no new capital flows into the country. Approximately \$40 billion of the \$560 billion in equity inflows to India from 2014-15 to 2025-26 (up to December) fall into this category. Large transactions, such as Bosch and Meesho Technologies, can skew annual inflow and sectoral trends.

Disinvestment drives decline

Before looking at why net FDI is low or even negative in certain months, it is worth mentioning that the official narrative that profit repatriation depresses net FDI is misleading.

Under BoP conventions, profits sent as dividends are recorded as investment income in the current account. They increase the current account deficit (CAD) but do not change the reported net FDI flows. Instead, the primary reason for weak net FDI is disinvestment and capital repatriation, which appear in the financial account.

Likewise, the increase in Outward Foreign Direct Investment (OFDI) warrants closer examination rather than being attributed solely to corporate maturity. From 2023-24 to 2025-26, 45% of India's total outbound investment of

\$65 billion went into the "financial, insurance, and business services" (FIB) sector. Singapore and the UAE accounted for 27% and 11% of the total, respectively. These funds mostly go to holding companies and SPVs rather than directly to operational entities. For instance, TML Commercial Vehicles, a subsidiary of Tata Motors, invested \$405 million in a Singaporean FIB entity to acquire the IVECO Group in Italy.

Capital movements through the GIFT City further complicate this issue. OFDI to the City increased from \$246 million in 2023-24 to \$1.18 billion in 2025-26. Total OFDI and inward FDI through it until 2025-26 reached \$2.35 billion and \$1.40 billion, respectively, highlighting the growing two-way flows.

These cross-flow of investments by Indian entities, also from other locations, indicates that OFDI can represent both genuine corporate expansion and the return of capital that fled. Therefore, increasing OFDI may not necessarily indicate maturity, as Indian companies might seek resources and technology, while a few might recycle capital through different jurisdictions.

Understanding the outflow channels

From 2022-23 to 2025-26, total FDI inflows and related current and capital account outflows reached significant levels. While gross inward equity FDI totalled \$317.80 billion (\$230.60 billion excluding reinvested earnings), the outflows present a more complex scenario.

Disinvestment and capital repatriation (capital account) totalled \$178.9 billion, primarily driven by financial investors through secondary and strategic sales, IPO exits, and share buybacks. This also includes "offers for sale" by foreign promoters such as Hyundai and LG. The other type involves sell-offs by RFDI investors, such as Wistron which sold off to the Tatas.

Dividend remittances (current account) amounted to \$118.9 billion in profits paid out by MNE subsidiaries and affiliates, excluding reinvested earnings.

Attributable IPR payments (current account) totalled \$46.6 billion. These payments, made by MNE subsidiaries and affiliates for intellectual property (assuming they account for 75% of total IPR payments), can substitute dividends.

Additionally, \$250.0 billion was transferred by all entities for technical/service/consultancy payments. However, it is difficult to divide this amount between RFDI and domestic companies.

Even when excluding OFDI and technical service payments, outflows due to disinvestment, dividends, and IPR payments (royalties) totalled \$344.4 billion. Therefore, for every dollar of fresh inflow (excluding reinvested earnings), approximately \$1.50 flowed out. This situation has worsened over the past 12 years. The corresponding outflow per dollar entered was 56 cents from 2014-15 to 2017-18, rising to 70 cents from 2018-19 to 2021-22, before reaching the current high.

Need for informed debate

The above narrative shows how an incomplete view of FDI prevails in the public discourse. Different types of investors, entry methods, and exit strategies impact technology transfer, industrial growth, and external sustainability. The reporting of global FDI flows adds an additional layer of problems. Understanding these nuances is crucial for evaluating FDI beyond headline numbers.

(K.S. Chalapati Rao is Senior Research Fellow at the Academy of Business Studies, Biswajit Dhar is former Professor, Jawaharlal Nehru University, and K.V.K. Ranganathan is an independent researcher)

THE GIST

▼
Real FDI accounted for 41.9% of effective inflows between 2022-23 and 2025-26, while financial investors contributed 40.5%, reflecting the growing role of private equity, venture capital, and sovereign wealth funds.

▼
Real FDI into manufacturing has declined across three consecutive four-year periods, with manufacturing receiving only 10.6% of total effective inflows in the latest period.

▼
Gross FDI figures include transactions such as intra-group ownership reorganisations, mergers, share swaps, and conversion of external commercial borrowings, even when no fresh capital enters the country.

